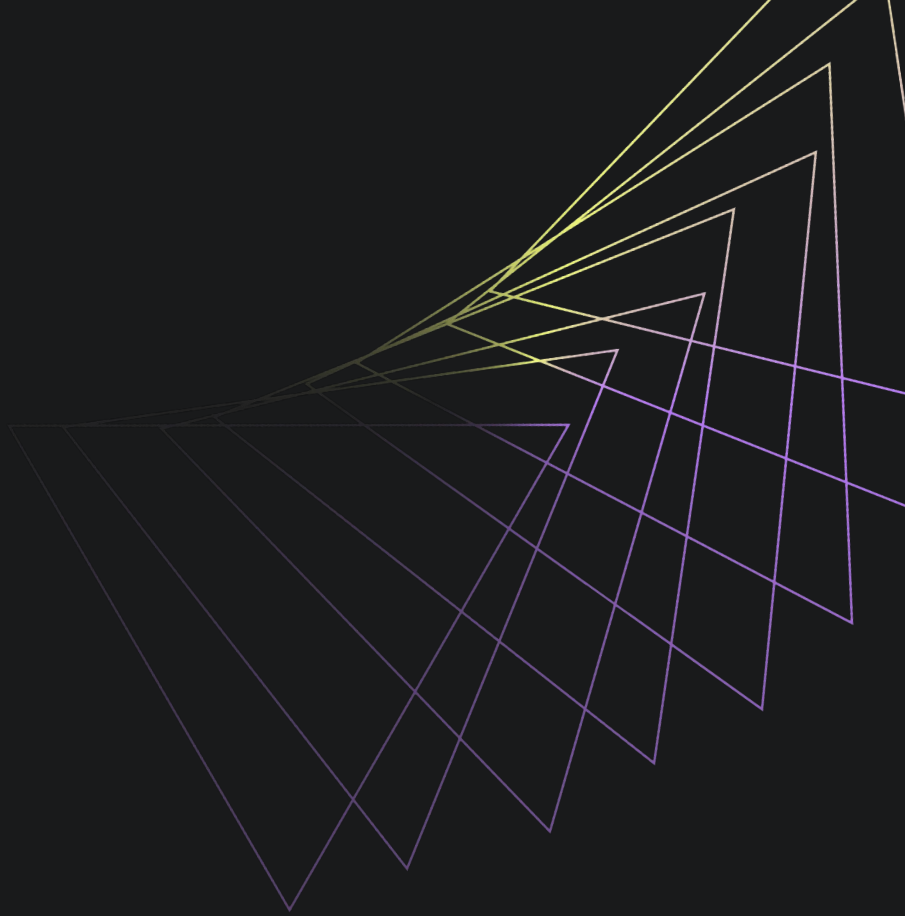
Gastón Perazzo Portfolio

Product & UX Research Specialist
Product Strategy and Experimentation



To illustrate exemplar projects I've worked on, the following case studies have been summarized in order to focus the present document on the implemented strategies and methodologies, as well as the conclusions obtained for each case.

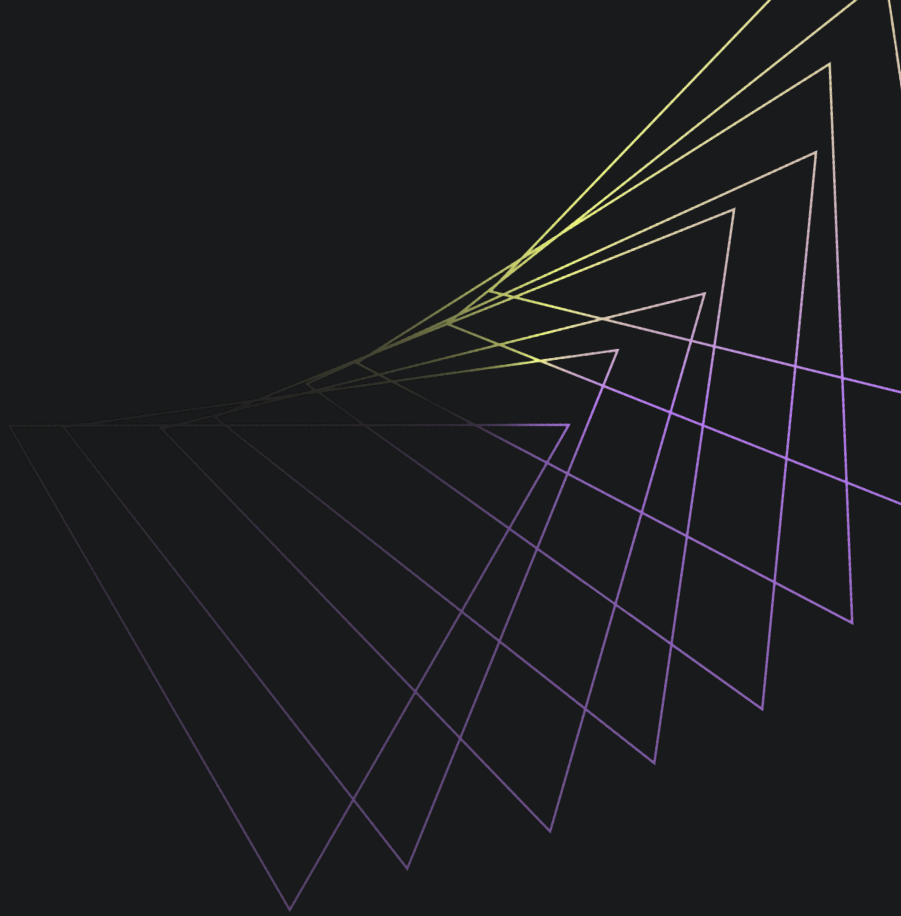
Every case presented here was developed under the following premises:

- UX & Product Research provides an essential foundation for strategic design by collecting data to back the product strategy and design decisions, thus helping create an optimal product for the users.

- Product Research utilizes business goals as a driver**.** The idea behind the digital product built is to provide value to not only the users, but the company as well.

Cases

- Chat Crecer
- Special Olympics
- Santander Uruguay
- Connect Teletherapy
- Ueno Bank: Loans
- Ueno Bank: Upay

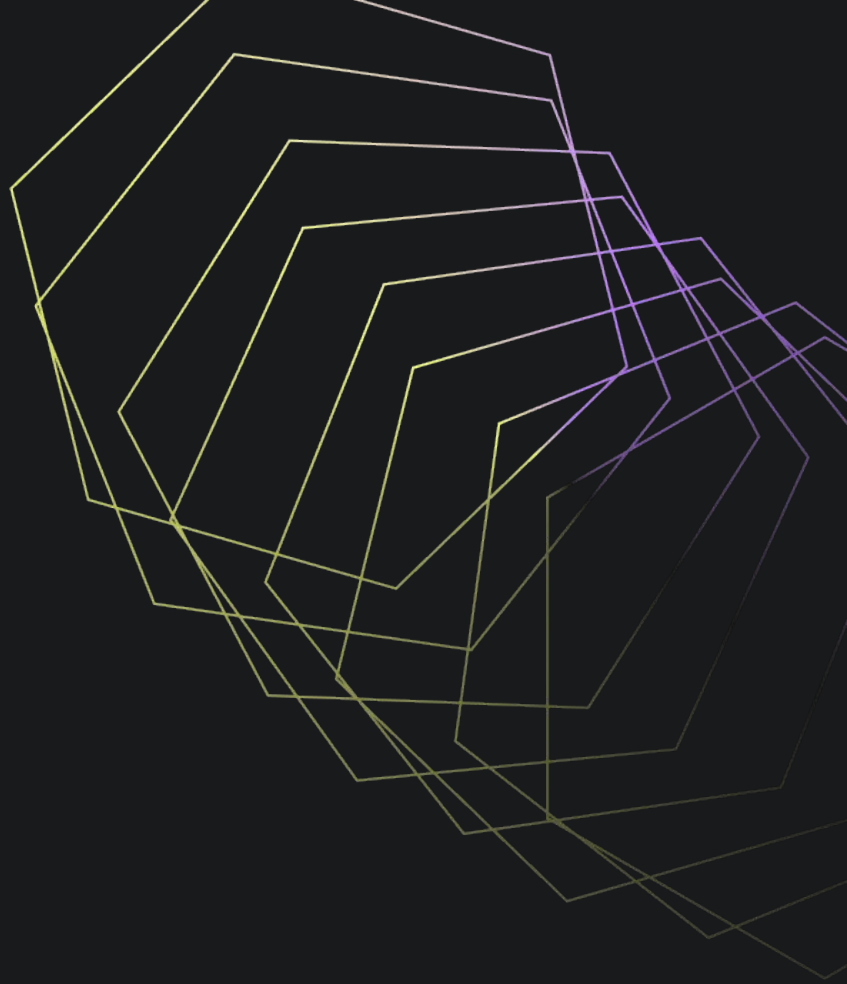


Case 1

Chat Crecer

Argentina.gob.ar

A virtual assistant for pregnancy and early years



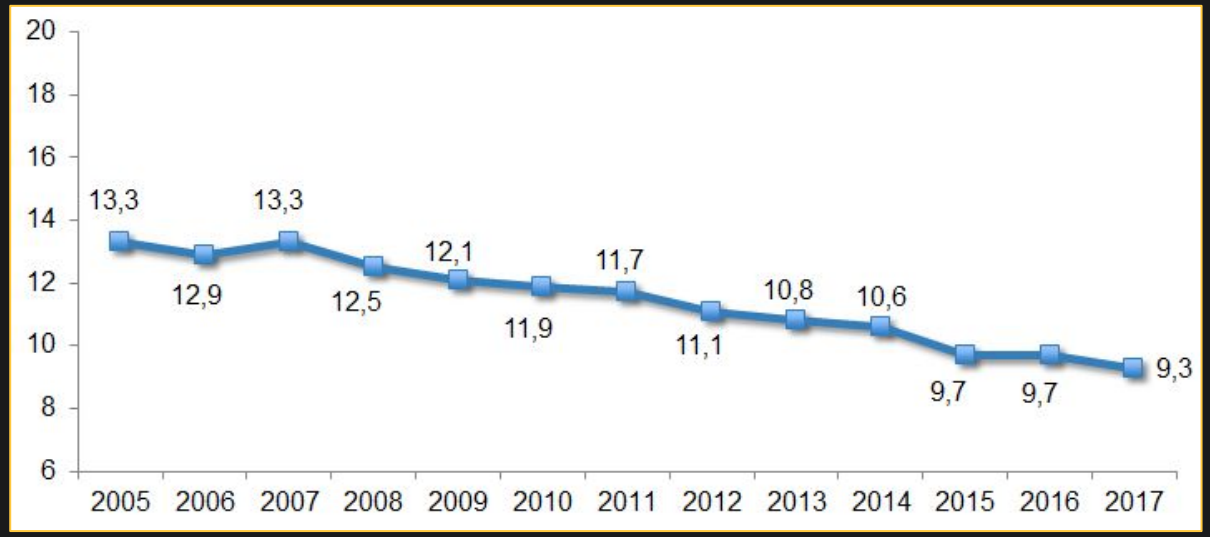
The initial request

The Sub-secretary of Motherhood and Infancy of the Ministry of Health asked our team to create a digital tool to help increase the number of medical check-ups performed by pregnant women, which directly impacts the number of maternal and child mortality in Argentina.

The problem

Index

CHILD MORTALITY RATE (every 1000 born alive)

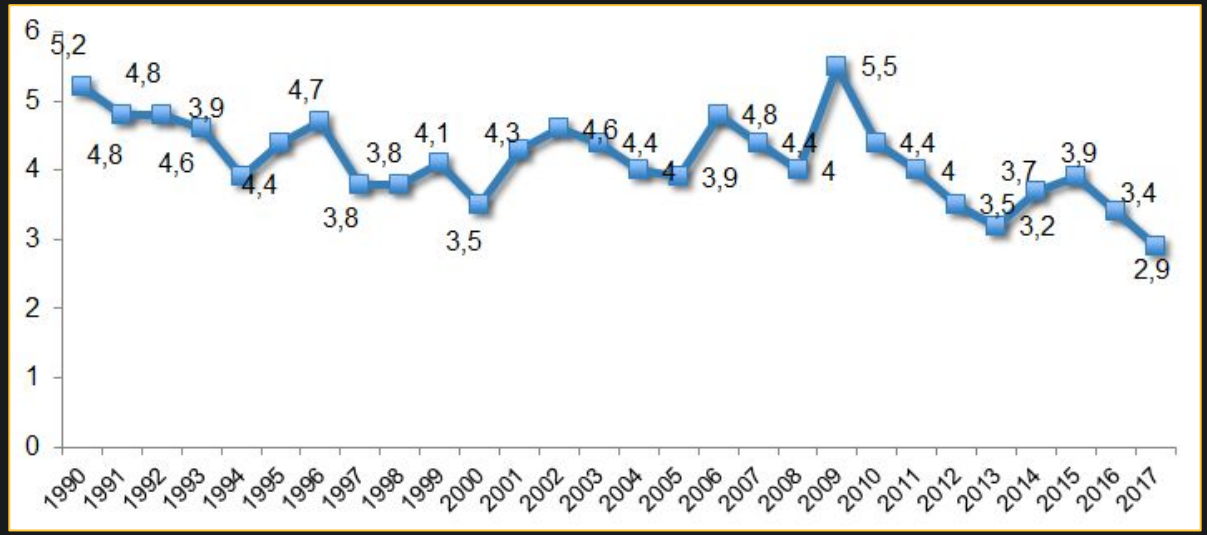


Directorate of Health Statistics and Information. National Ministry of Health 2005–2017

The problem

Index

MOTHER MORTALITY RATE (every 1000 born alive)



Directorate of Health Statistics and Information. National Ministry of Health 2005–2017

The objectives of the project

Increase the number of prenatal check-ups and ensure they are timely

Provide **quality information about maternity and early childhood**

Facilitate **access to information** about government support and benefits, thus empowering women

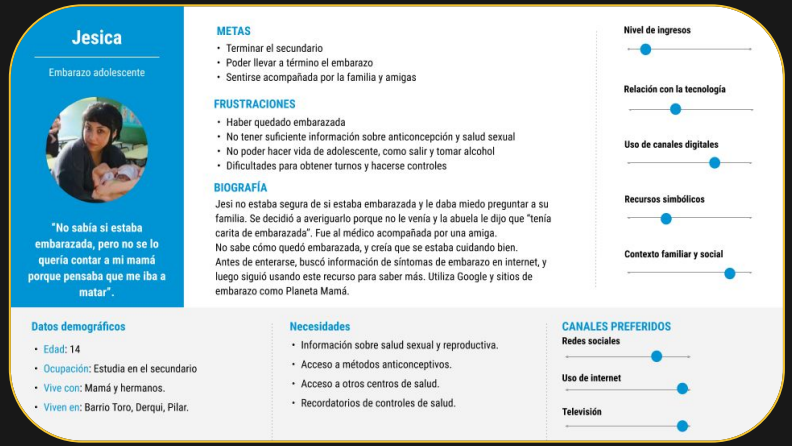
Support and accompany as many women as possible during pregnancy and the baby's first year

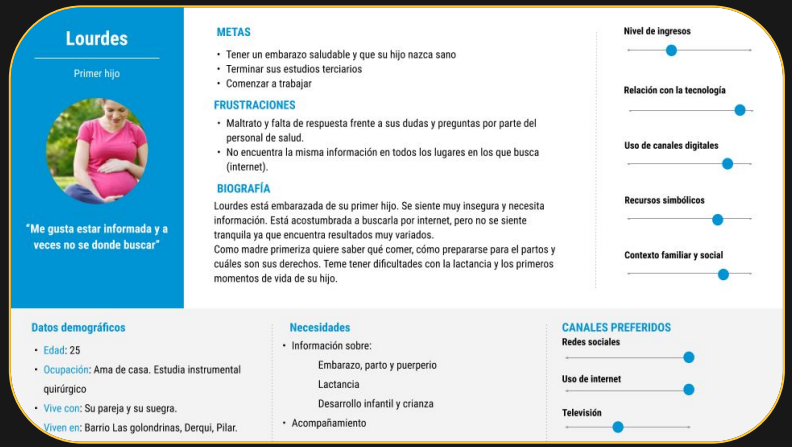
Index

What we did

We conducted in-situ interviews with low-income women and maternity ward doctors to gain insights into their needs and experiences.

These insights informed the creation of a comprehensive product canvas that combined resources from the Ministry of Health with the specific needs of both mothers and doctors. We also developed Personas based on the key information gathered during the interviews.



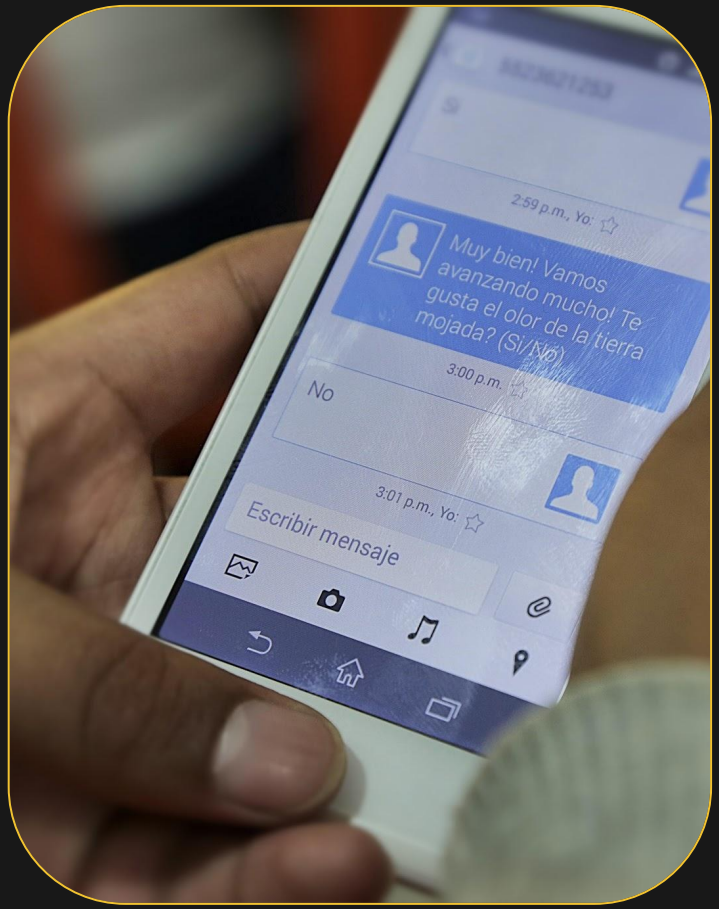


Index

What we did

We also researched similar solutions from around the world, uncovering various products that use different communication channels to engage users.

While we found mobile apps and SMS systems addressing similar topics, we did not find any chatbots focused on this area. This presented a unique opportunity to create an innovative solution tailored to the needs of our target audience.



We learned that our users

- They used low to mid-range cell phones.
- They didn't always have or knew their email address. In this line, they frequently changed their phone numbers and usually didn't own a landline.
- They lacked money for data, and their phone memory was limited.
- They were highly interested in learning more about their pregnancy. They often searched for information on the internet but often end up on unofficial websites.
- They used Facebook on their mobile phones.

Case 1

Building the chat

We chose a Facebook chat so they wouldn't have to learn something new and could have a seamless conversation to access information.

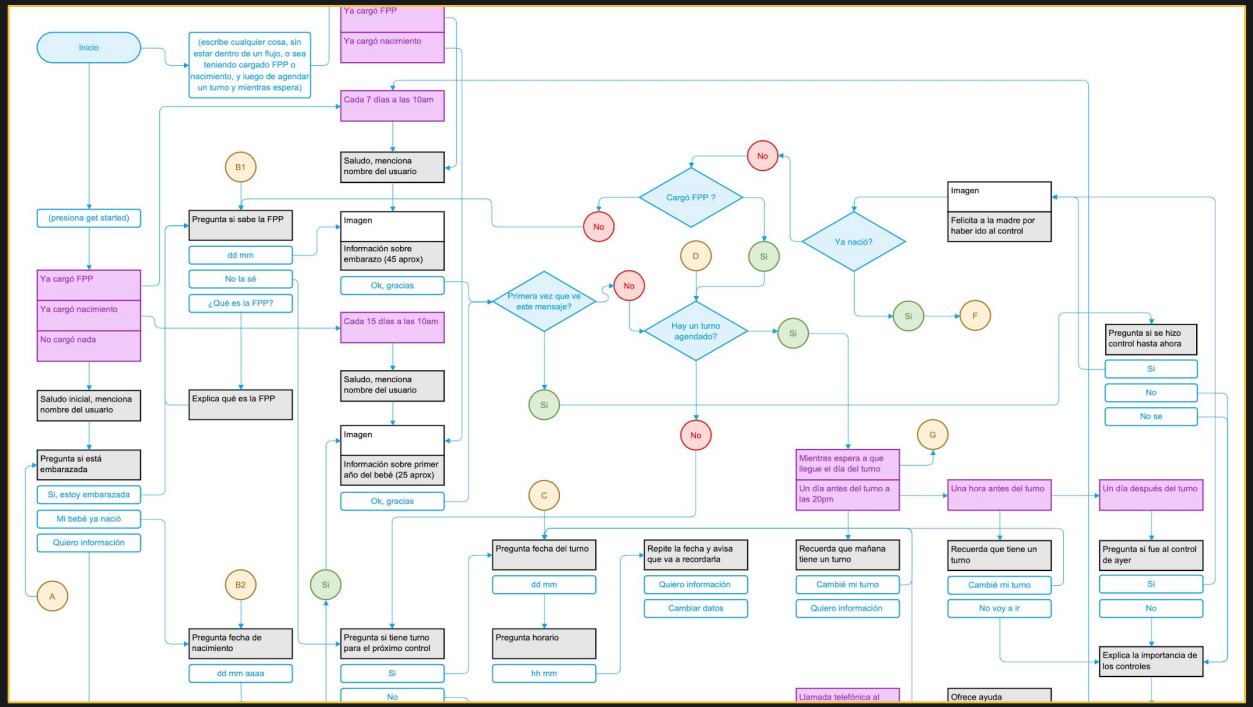
We transformed the Ministry of Health's information into an engaging conversation. Chat Crecer supported pregnant women and new mothers by scheduling medical appointments and providing weekly updates on breastfeeding, childbirth, pregnancy, postpartum care, vaccinations, rights, and benefits.



Index

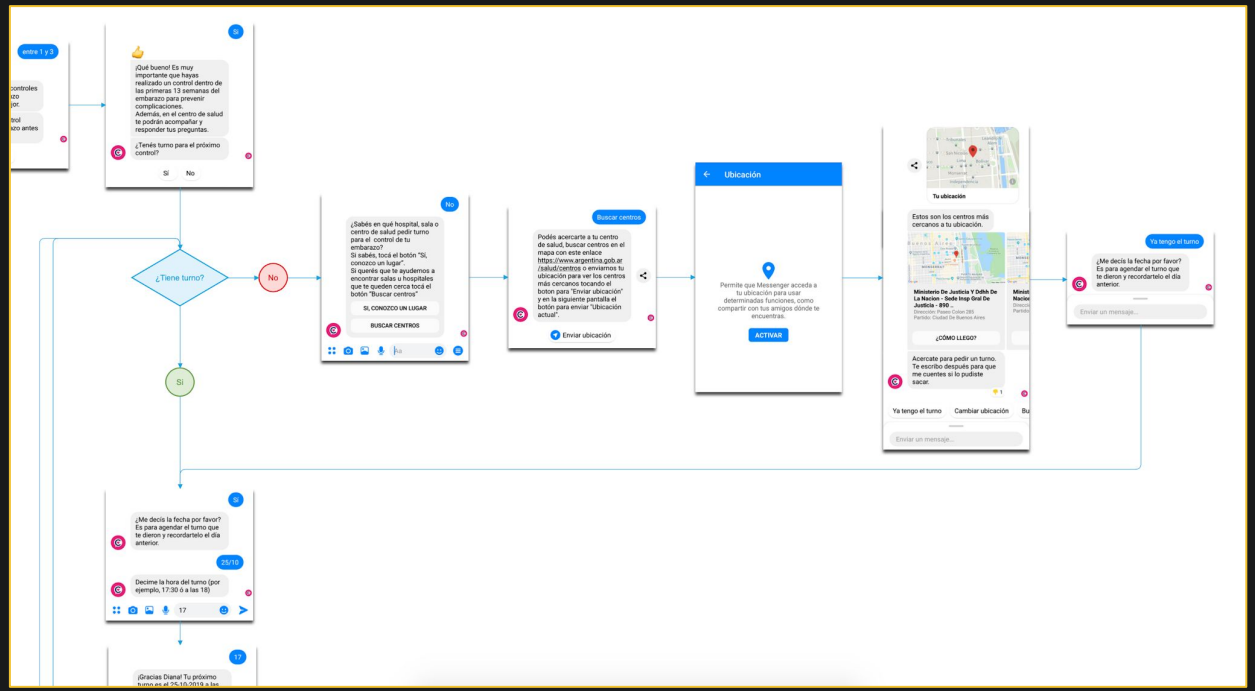
Conversation flow (intro and check-ups loop)

Index



Conversation flow with screens from the chatbot

Index

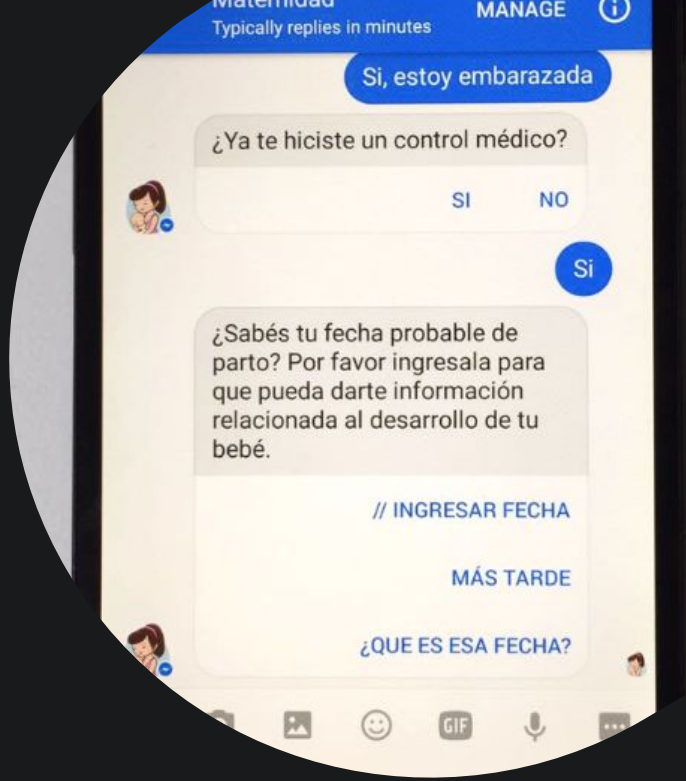


Case 1

Testing fast and low cost

We quickly created a prototype on Facebook Messenger and conducted interviews and usability tests with users.

This allowed us to test the onboarding process and the medical check-up reminder flow, ensuring both were easy to understand and use. By testing fast and cost-effectively, we were able to refine the solution based on real user feedback.

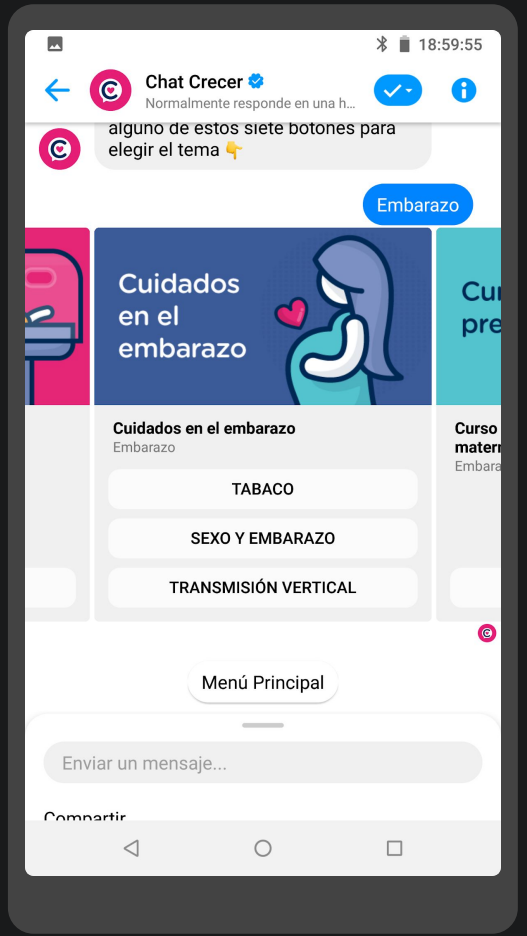


Index

Case 1

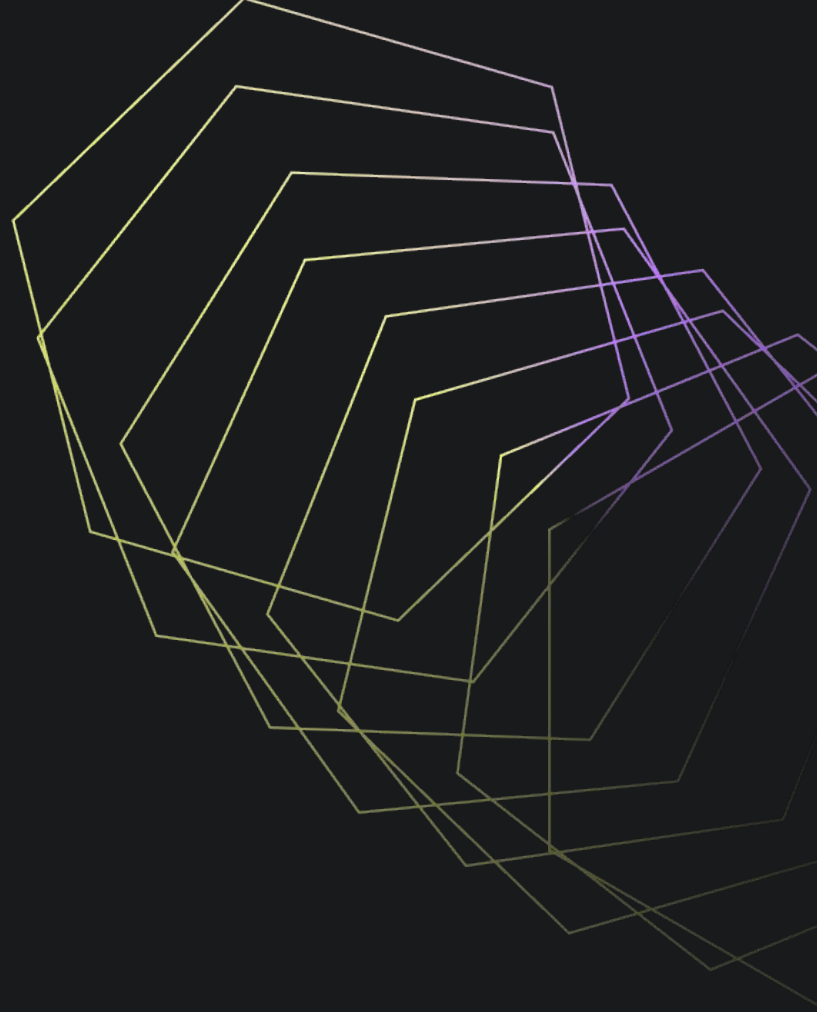
The features developed included

- Reminders of medical checkups
- Map with nearby hospitals to call
- Personalized information every week based on the data the mother gave on the onboarding
- Medical and legal information about maternity



Pilot and results

Testing on a maternity ward



Our pilot test

We run a three months pilot test on maternity wards from Pilar district and got around 4000 pregnant woman and mothers to use the chatbot. We posted ads on the maternity wards and have informational flyers to give away.

On that instance we could do research on every user conversation to improve flows and misunderstandings, and also to add medical information that was on demand.

Test data

More than **4000 active users. 97% of them said the tool was easy to use.**

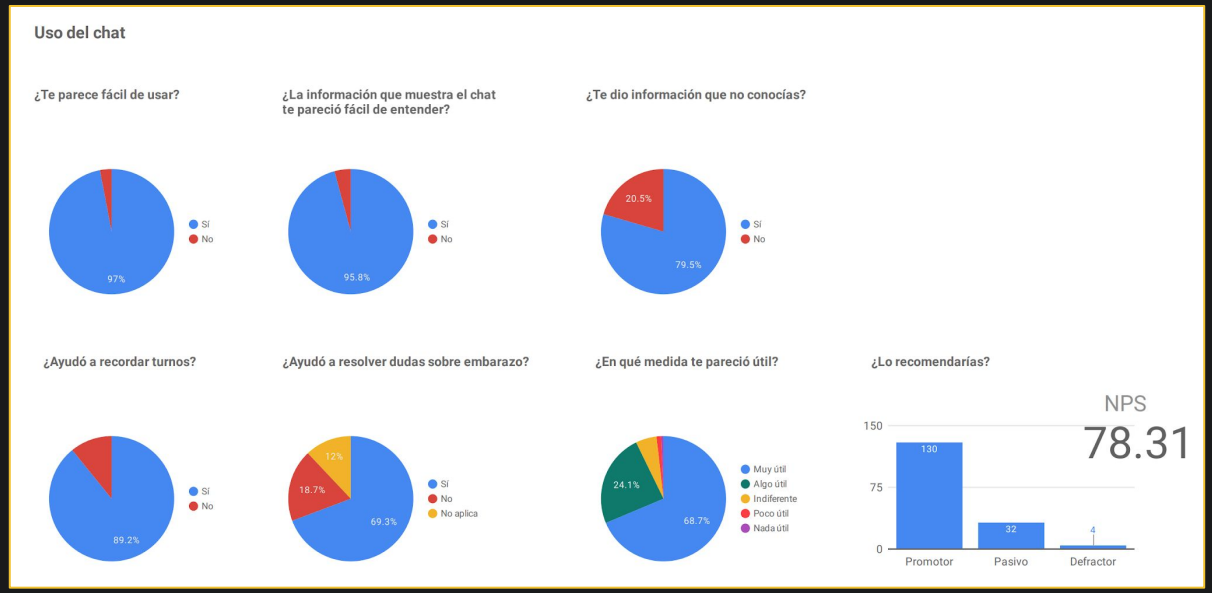
79% of the users said they obtained information that they did not know

89% of the users recalled a medical appointment thanks to the chatbot

The chatbot got a NPS score of 78. Doctors and health authorities indicated an increase in medical check-ups in that district

Survey done at the end of the pilot test (results)

Index



Final Results

Our team successfully delivered a product that not only provided valuable content but also fostered a genuine and caring relationship with the users.

Through this achievement, we made a significant impact on the health system and positively influenced the lives of all the mothers who utilized the chatbot and our platform

Our efforts resulted in tangible improvements and better experiences for those we served.

Case 2

Special Olympics

Helping families through their child's development

The Client

In 2023 Special Olympics approached us with an interesting challenge. They provided year-round sports training and athletic competition in a variety of sports for children and adults with intellectual disabilities, giving them continuing opportunities to develop physical fitness and participate in the sharing of skills and friendships with their families and their community.

The Problem

Amid the pandemic, many families lost contact with this organization and each other.

When they partnered with us to develop a multi-platform mobile app, their mission was clear: foster social change and build inclusive communities by guiding parents and caregivers through child development with age-appropriate activities, while also creating an online forum to engage, educate, and connect families.

Index

What we did

We conducted **20** individual interviews, which we sliced up according to the following characteristics:

- Caregivers, coaches and family members w/ children w/ IDD between the ages of 2 - 7
- Only USA
- Families w/ formal and informal IDD diagnosis

Profession	Child's age	IDD
Pediatrician	4	High functional Autism
Architect	22	Down Syndrome
College professor	11	Autism and ADHD
IT Professional	27, 22, 14	Autism and slow learners
Housewife	21	Autism
Retired Headmistress	27	Autism
Housewife	23	Down Syndrome
Public employee	24	Autism
Associated Professor	29	Down Syndrome
Associated Professor	27	Down Syndrome
usewife/works at SO	4	Down Syndrome

Key insights and a new prioritization

Community: connect with other families

The ability to connect with other families was the app's most crucial feature. This connection helped combat isolation and denial, with early acceptance and overcoming denial recurring in every testimony. Support networks of families, whether they've transitioned through this stage or are still navigating it, were just as vital as professional or medical support.

The reasons behind new necessities

Get support and guidance from **someone “on the same journey as I”**

Gatherings **to promote awareness and inclusion between the families**

To be able to hear and share experiences that might help **on daily basis** (specialized content is often not focused on every day’s routine)

Find out about **events happening, new accessible content and receive news about the local community** (schools, gyms, special courses**)**

Index

> *This just happens to really bring our community together and we're thankful for that.*

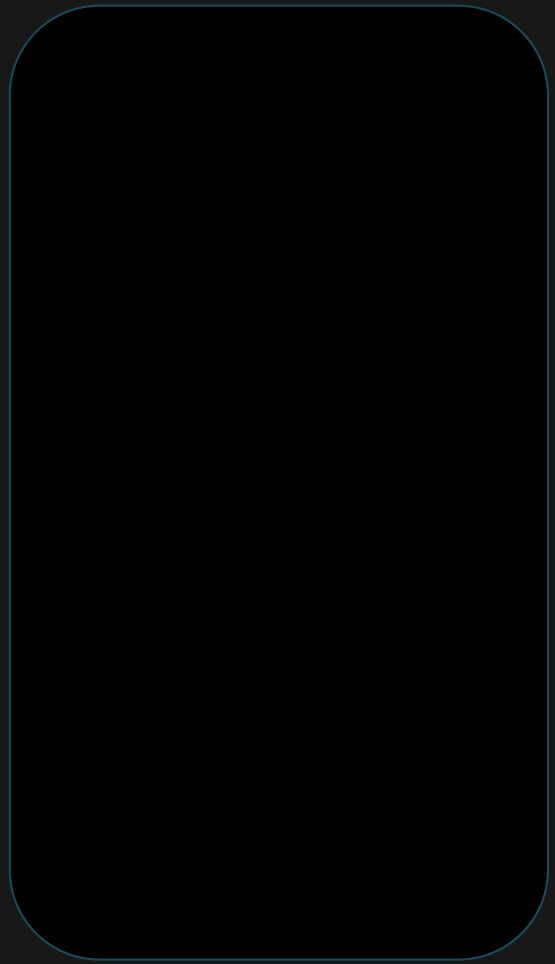
Index

Testing the app

We conducted Usability Testing sessions, with:

- Parents and caregivers
- Coaches and Program Administrators

This enabled us to collect valuable insights, which informed a re-prioritization of our product roadmap. With this data-driven approach, we were able to strategically realign our development efforts and effectively plan the product launch.



Our Next Steps



We defined event tracking and collect metrics



We worked on our carry overs and started working on new features.



We tested the new features & define experiments based on metrics and user performance



We launch the V1

Case 3

Santander Uruguay

Digital Bank Transformation and Client-Centric Solutions

The Client

in 2024 Santander Uruguay embarked on a project to implement a New Digital Bank in Uruguay that represented a transformative shift, to provide a seamless, fully digital experience for clients, making banking more agile, accessible, and in tune with the evolving needs of Uruguayan customers.

The Problem

The bank needed to ensure that its mobile app and online banking services aligned with each customer segment's unique needs and expectations while improving overall engagement and satisfaction.

They approached Rootstrap intending to identify key opportunities for digital transformation and ensure their digital offerings were meeting client expectations across all demographics.

The objectives of the project

Uncover **opportunities to innovate** within the banking app and digital services

Understand the distinct **needs of Santander's different client segments and how their digital experience could be enhanced**

Develop a diagnosis for their digital transformation and **help the bank prioritize features and iterations with their strategic goals**

Our Approach

In this Discovery Process the close collaboration between the Product Manager and the Product Researcher formed a cornerstone of our approach. We worked in tandem to ensure a holistic and strategic alignment between research insights and business goals, and by combining these perspectives, we aimed to craft solutions that are both user-centric and business-driven

Index

What we did

Conduct **+ 72 in-depth user interviews** with various client segments, product owners, and high-level stakeholders from Santander.

Moderate a **collaborative workshop with various subject matter experts** at the bank.

Engage with Santander's management and product owners to align findings with business objectives.

Index

What we delivered

Persona Development and Journey Mapping

Based on user interviews, we developed comprehensive Personas for each client profile, identifying their banking needs and digital behaviors. This process allowed us to identify key touchpoints in their journey and highlight critical moments in the user experience where digital solutions could make a significant impact.

Index

What we delivered

University base student
Mariana



Comportamiento

- Además de la cuenta universitaria, si trabajan tienen cuentas sueldo en uno o varios bancos.
- Determinan que banco usar por el banco en el que para la empresa donde trabajan.
- Utilizan el banco de forma limitada solo para operar las transacciones básicas.
- Suelen usar tarjeta de credit Pros porque tiene cero costo de mantenimiento y para controlar sus gastos
- No suele tener tarjeta de crédito
- El nivel de consumo no amerita el mantenimiento de la TC

Necesidades

- Que el banco no les cobre mantenimiento alto por cuenta o tarjeta
- Valoran la accesibilidad y rapidez en las gestiones bancarias.

Bloqueantes y barreras

- Suelen no tener capacidad de ahorro
- La ausencia de información de los productos del banco los obliga a tener que asistir a los canales de atención
- Por el momento no tienen intenciones de invertir, el foco es terminar la carrera

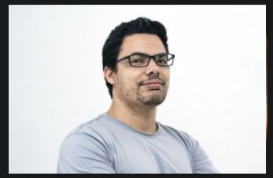
Features & Mejoras deseadas

- Crear cajas de ahorro con rendimiento. Ejemplo: Nubank y Revolut
- Tarjeta de crédito sin costos
- Gestión de límite de tarjeta de crédito como control de gastos

Oportunidades y Recomendaciones para el segmento

- No expresaron grandes disconformidades con el banco Santander. Se enfocan a lo que las entidades le ofrecen, sin cuestionamiento
- Suelen utilizar las operaciones mas básicas
- Transparencia y simplicidad en la comunicación
- Costos bajos en el mantenimiento de la cuenta y su TC
- Educación financiera y gestión de ahorro

University superior student
Santiago



Comportamiento

- Tiene varios bancos en los cuales que trabaja y cuentas sueldo en los cuales mantenimiento. Además de la cuenta universitaria, si trabajan tienen cuentas sueldo en uno o varios bancos.
- Hay un alto grado de influencia de su entorno para seleccionar la entidad bancaria.
- Usan Pros por seguridad. Si las operaciones en el proceso de retiene en cumplido y no confían en que los bancos no reembolsan los gastos realizados.
- Prefieren pagar con QR porque es más práctico y seguro. No tiene riesgo de ser robado y no se pueden robar o clonar.
- El nivel de consumo no amerita el mantenimiento de la TC
- Son más entusiastas e inquietos que Universitaria N°1. Buscan crecer en el negocio o adelgazarlo o incluso aspiran a emprender

Necesidades

- Los costos de mantenimiento TC
- Que el banco no les cobre para tener el producto: usan DCA y Pros por este motivo.
- En el mediano plazo no tienen aspiraciones por ser jóvenes. Hipotecarios, sus ahorros los visualizan para estudiar este volcarse a empresas
- Poder autosegestionar todas las operaciones bancarias sin necesidad de ir al banco
- Buscan inmediatez y transparencia
- Una tarjeta de crédito sagaz y fácil de gestionar

Bloqueantes y barreras

- Quienes invierten la hacen con conocimiento limitado y montos pequeños
- La ausencia de información de los productos del banco los obliga a tener que asistir a los canales de atención
- Productos digitales con mala usabilidad

Features & Mejoras deseadas

- Crear cajas de ahorro con rendimiento. Ejemplo: Nubank y Revolut
- Crear una comunidad que genere fidelidad con la entidad y sus productos
- Tarjeta de crédito sin costos
- Autogestionar tarjeta de crédito
- TC que les permitan operar con plataformas de cripto o videojuegos
- Brindar formación en finanzas personales y gestión de ahorro

Oportunidades y Recomendaciones para el segmento

- Suelen utilizar las operaciones más básicas
- Para invertir operan con otras aplicaciones como Binance, Ppex, otras.
- Transparencia y simplicidad en la comunicación
- Costos bajos en el mantenimiento de la cuenta y su TC
- Symbio de pertenencia con la entidad
- Educación financiera y gestión de ahorro

Index

What we delivered

Market Analysis

We built an extensive benchmark analysis that went beyond interface comparisons. We focused on evaluating the value propositions and business strategies of competitive offerings in the market, which allowed us to pinpoint unique aspects of different competitors that we understood as an improvement within the long-term strategy of Santander.

Index

What we delivered

Benchmark - investments

Revolut

Standar Plan: free account

- **Flexible account:** Annual yield of 3% - 4% with on-demand funds, Capital + interest available daily
  - Capital + interest available daily
- Highlights:
  - Low-cost international transfers
  - Competitive exchange rates in 36 currencies



Index

What we delivered

Benchmark

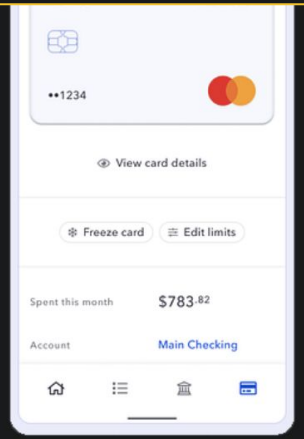
Mercury

With an online LLC of $400 you can open an account.
No need to be USA Citizen

Account approval within 2-4 days

You can charge money even before having the account validated





Index

What we delivered

Key Insights & Findings

We worked to identify business opportunities and improve the digital experience, helping prioritize features and improve the value proposition of their mobile app and online platform.

- Improving the app's user experience through real-time information, simpler information architecture, and better transaction and statement visualization.
- Providing clearer product and service details to reduce the need for personal support.
- Measuring and analyzing every stage of the New Banking system for data-driven decisions.

Final Results

Our Discovery provided Santander Uruguay with a customer-centric diagnosis for their digital transformation, fully aligned with their strategic goals. By helping the bank enhance customer engagement and satisfaction through targeted digital services, we also equipped them with the necessary insights to align the initial hypotheses of key stakeholders with real user needs and expectations.

This alignment became the primary foundation for building their new digital banking platform

Case 4

Connect Teletherapy

Providing high-quality virtual therapy services for kids

The Client

Connect Teletherapy is a therapist-owned and operated business that provides high-quality virtual therapy services for kids, and understands the challenges parents and schools face in accessing the right therapy options for children.

Their mission was to offer online speech therapy, occupational therapy, mental health counseling, and physical therapy services for both schools and families, making it a convenient and effective solution.

The Problem

The client needed partner to assist with the development of a virtual therapy platform. This solution aimed to expand upon an existing offering by providing a differentiated, unique, and innovative approach to virtual speech therapy.

Their distinctive approach focused on:

- Building Genuine Connections: prioritizing forming trust-based relationships between the child and the dedicated therapists in various disciplines.

- Empowering Interests and Development: committed to helping children thrive in therapy and life, giving them more time for hobbies, outdoor activities, and community involvement.

Case 4

The objectives of the project

Identify the main **pain points and challenges faced by parents and therapists** in accessing and utilizing virtual therapy services

Identify the **goals families and therapists aim to achieve by** using the services of virtual counseling

Evaluate the efficiency of online therapy services, identifying **obstacles and opportunities to improve** acquisition, conversion rates, and business growth

Our Approach

1 Product Vision

1 Week

Activities

- Understand the business model: What problem(s) are we solving, the value proposition, known competitors, established business goals and product success metrics
- Review the product vision: What do you want to build and why?
- Understand the domain.
- Define users: Target segments, create user personas
- Align on research goals and plan.
  - Contact users that will participate in the process and setup interviews
  - Create and validate scripts that will be used for the research sessions

2 Explorative Research

2 Weeks

Activities

- Research:
  - Conduct interviews to understand their current experience.
  - Analyze data gathered in interviews
- Adjust customer journey with insights from the research stage
- PoC to validate feasibility (if applicable)

3 Product Definition

2 Weeks

Activities

- User-story mapping (high level - main flows) and prioritization session
  - Validation sessions with product and tech resources
  - High-level estimation
- Map high-level technical requirements and risks
- Happy path wireframes
- UI exploration and confirmation
- Finish interactive prototype of user flows' happy path
- Conclusion on the feasibility
- Technical definitions such as architecture and tech stack (if applicable)
- Define a prioritized product roadmap: MVP and future releases

Index

What we did

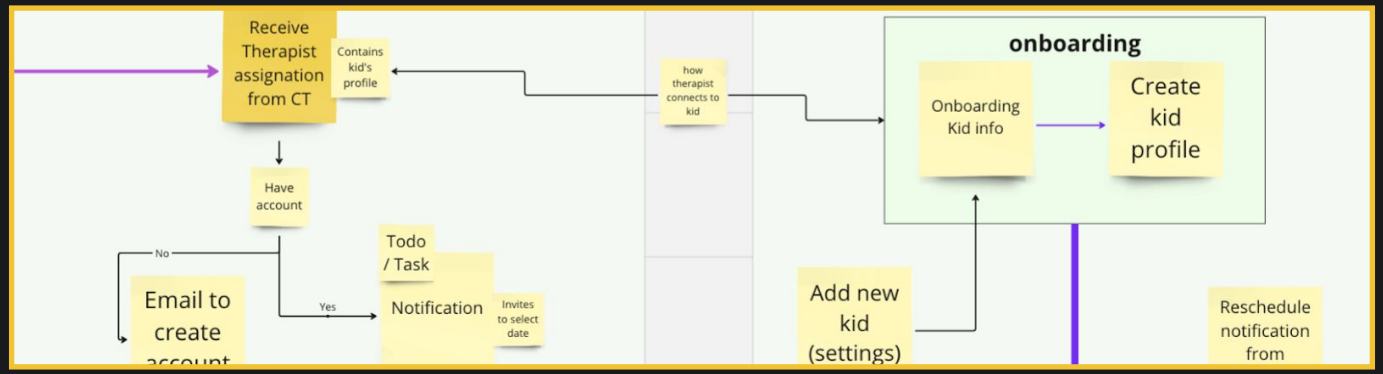
We delved into how the Therapists & Counselors - Schools' workflow would work and conducted thorough research to explore how other companies were addressing similar problems and needs. This involved conducting a robust benchmark analysis to glean insights and best practices from the industry landscape.

After performing our market research, we developed provisional Personas that would help us better define the users' situations and expectations and we worked also on ideal journeys for our target demographic.

Index

What we did

We initiated a Research Phase to understand if users' needs aligned with the desired functionalities from our Client and to refine the prioritization of our Roadmap. Simultaneously, we began working on wireframes to explore core mechanics.



Index

What we did

Conducted **25 in-depth user interviews** with various client segments, including:

- Occupational Therapists
- Speech Therapists
- School Counselors
- Families

Moderated a **collaborative workshop with subject matter experts** from Connect.

We then produced a clusterization of insights based on the segment that provided them and the nature of the pain points & needs.

Final Results

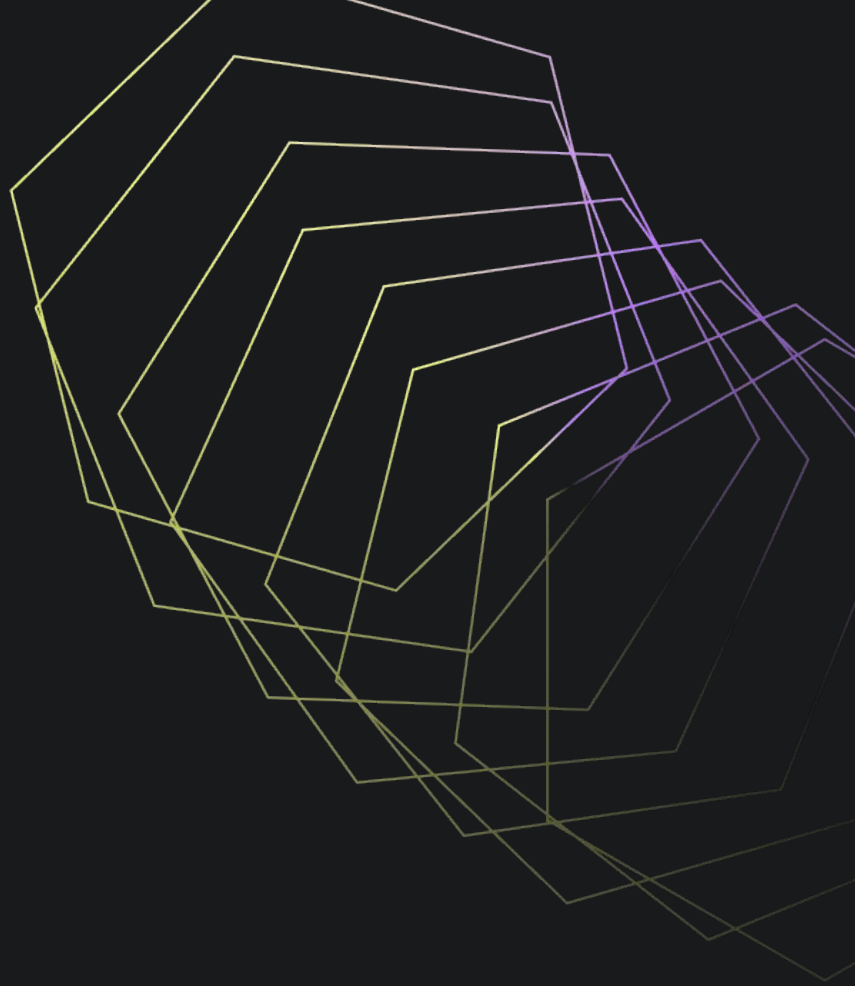
The collaboration between the Design, Product, and Development teams during Discovery was key in validating our client's requirements against user needs. This gave us deeper insights into the online therapy landscape and how Connect Teletherapy Value Proposition could best meet market demands. As a result, we gauged the effort required to launch a user-centered product and defined the scope for future iterations.

Beyond setting features and business goals, we recognized that Connect Teletherapy impact goes further—building lasting connections between Mental Health Professionals and families became a crucial objective.

Case 5

Ueno Bank: Loans

Understanding Loan Conversion through Analytics, Research & Behavioral Science



The Challenge

The Loans team at Ueno Bank identified a low conversion rate in the loan application journey. Many users entered the loan simulation, but only a small proportion moved forward to complete an application.

The team needed to understand where users were dropping off, what was preventing them from progressing, and which opportunities could help improve conversion.

Understanding What Was Behind the Drop-Off

The initial conversion issue did not point to a single, clearly defined cause.

Although **Base** and **Plus** users represented an important share of the journey, the team needed a clearer picture of how behavior differed across customer segments and what was driving abandonment.

We approached the problem from two complementary perspectives: understanding the experience within the product and exploring how customers responded to the way the loan offer was communicated.

Case 5

The objectives of the initiative

Identify **friction points** along the loan simulation and application journey

Understand the **technical and comprehension-related barriers** affecting the experience

Explore how **different messaging approaches influence engagement** across customer segments.

Evaluate whether **a stronger initial response translates into more loan applications** or renewals.

Our Multi-layered research approach

We combined three sources of evidence to diagnose the problem:

- Product analytics: behavioral patterns and funnel drop-offs.
- Customer feedback: CSAT and NPS scores, and open-ended comments.
- Customer Experience: support tickets and recurring reasons for contact.

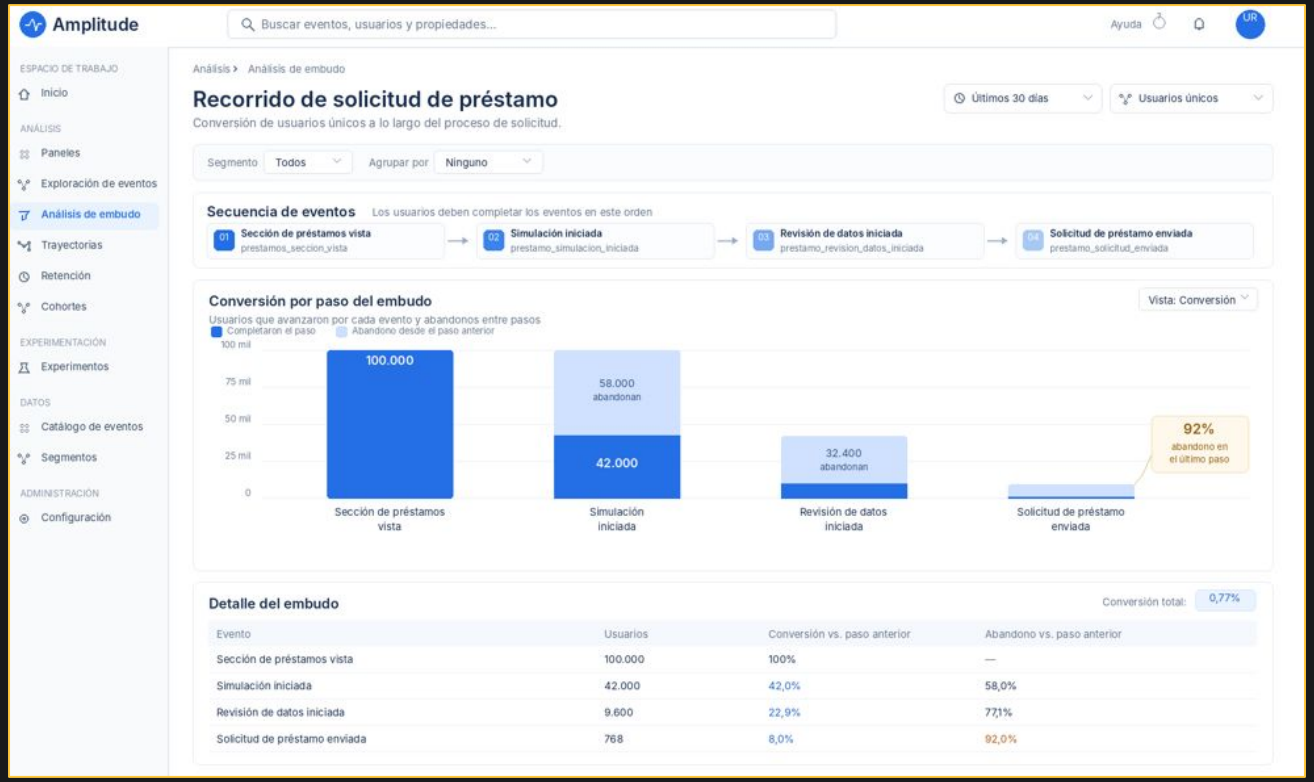
Index

Product Analytics

Mapping the Customer Journey

Using Amplitude, we analyzed events across the loan simulation and application journey to identify abandonment points, explore differences in behavior across customer segments, and It's evolution during 2025/2026.

This provided a behavioral view of the problem and helped frame the questions that required further investigation.



Illustrative reconstruction for this portfolio. Figures are approximate and do not correspond to historical data from Ueno Bank.

Index

Customer Feedback

Looking Beyond the numbers

We reviewed CSAT results and open-ended comments, and worked with the Customer Experience team to analyze support tickets related to the loan journey.

The evidence pointed to two types of friction:

- **Technical issues**: simulation or application flows that froze or did not work as expected.
- **Comprehension barriers**: questions about interest rates, loan terms and the total amount customers would eventually repay.

Together, these sources helped us explore potential explanations for the low conversion rate.

Case 5

Health Metrics Personas

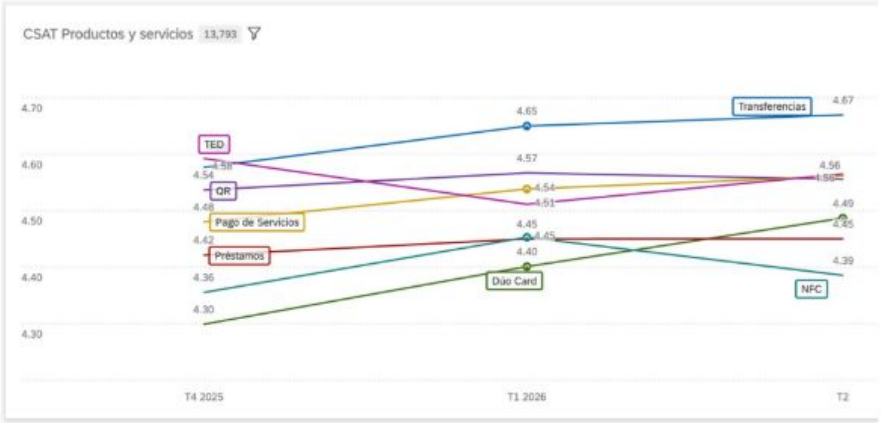
CSAT Productos

CSAT Dúo Card

4.49

Aumento significativo vs Q1

Se observa un **aumento significativo del CSAT de Dúo Card.** Pasando de 4.30 a 4.40 en Q1, y de 4.40 a 4.49 en Q2.



Fuente: Qualtrics. Las flechas en las líneas indican diferencia significativa con el período anterior.

Health Metrics Report Q2 2026 - Satisfaction score for all of the product units

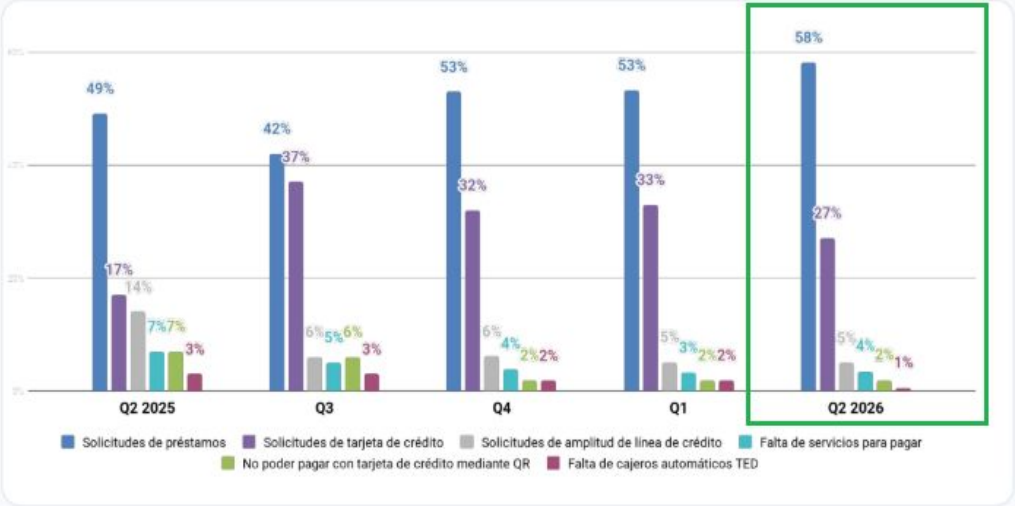
Case 5

Falta de oferta de productos y servicios

Falta de oferta
Evolutivo

En Q2 disminuyeron los comentarios relacionados a pedidos de TC y aumentaron los de Préstamos.

Esto puede vincularse con la el nuevo componente de oferta de TC que aumentó la conversión de 23.5% a 33.9%.



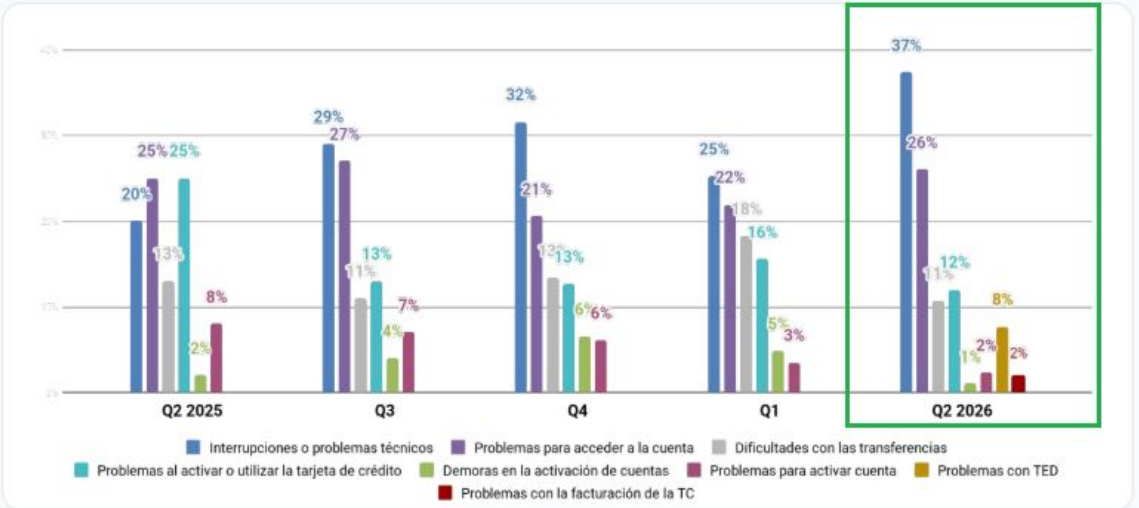
Source: Own elaboration based on cumulative comments 2025–2026. Comments sourced from NPS+CSAT, Product CSAT, Service & Resolution CSAT

Case 5

Problemas para operar

Problemas para operar
Evolutivo

Aumentaron los comentarios de fallas técnicas y de acceso a cuentas, mientras disminuyeron los de inconvenientes con transferencias y TC. No obstante, surgen nuevos dolores sobre TED y facturación de TC.



Source: Own elaboration based on cumulative comments 2025–2026. Comments sourced from NPS+CSAT, Product CSAT, Service & Resolution CSAT

Index

Two Complementary Workstreams

Our diagnosis informed **two parallel initiatives:**

1. Experience evaluation

We worked with Product and Design to investigate friction in the simulation and the transition to the application, using usability testing to inform potential improvements.

2. Behavioral messaging experiment

We explored whether alternative ways of presenting the loan offer could influence how customers responded to the proposition.

This allowed us to investigate both the experience of using the product and the response to the communication that encouraged users to enter the journey.

Case 5

1. Researching Experience-Related Frictions

In collaboration with Product and Design, we conducted usability testing with participants from the four customer segments: Base, Plus, Black and Ejecutive.

We focused on the loan simulation experience and the transition to the application, looking for comprehension difficulties, usability issues and opportunities to improve the existing experience.

Results: The findings supported the evaluation of potential product improvements already being considered in the backlog.



Case 5

2. Testing Different Ways to Frame the Offer

In parallel, we designed a behavioral messaging experiment using push notifications to evaluate how different communication approaches influenced customer response.

We compared a control group with alternative messaging variants informed by three behavioral principles:

- **Control:** Standard loan communication, without an intentional behavioral framing.
- **Social Norm:** Emphasizing how other people behave to encourage engagement.
- **Exclusivity:** Highlighting exclusive access or benefits.
- **Loss Aversion:** Emphasizing potential losses or the opportunity users might miss.

Users were randomly assigned to the control group or a variant, allowing us to compare their subsequent behavior.



Different notifications messages based on unique cognitive biases.

From Engagement to business outcomes

Before launching the experiment, we defined the behaviors we wanted to evaluate and the metrics that would indicate success.

- **Primary business KPI:**
  Loan application or renewal conversion rate, comparing the control group with the different messaging variants.
- **Engagement metric:**
  Push notification open rate, indicating the initial response to each message.

Results: Customer Response Varied by Segment

The experiment revealed different engagement patterns across customer segments.

- **Base and Plus**: Social Norm achieved the strongest open rate.
- **Black**: Exclusivity achieved the strongest open rate.

These differences suggested that the framing of the same underlying proposition could influence customer response differently across segments.

By tailoring messages to each segment, we could make the loan offer more salient to customers who might not otherwise consider it, creating an opportunity to bring more potential borrowers into the loan journey.

Results: Looking beyond the open rate

The most relevant business outcome emerged in the Plus segment.

Social Norm achieved the highest loan application or renewal rate compared with the control group and the other messaging variants.*

This was important because the strongest initial engagement for that segment was also accompanied by the strongest observed business outcome (the only push notification that achieved this).
And also help us define the next steps: evaluate which interventions to prioritize by segment, formulate new hypotheses and continue monitoring engagement and conversion before scaling.

*We linked user IDs to the corresponding experimental assignments and used Amplitude events and properties to follow downstream behavior. We then compared results across variants and customer segments, assessing the differences using a statistical significance criterion.

Case 6

Ueno Bank: Upay

Product Analytics and Generative Research to rethink the Subscription Value Proposition

Business context

Upay had distributed POS terminals to independent merchants, PYME and larger businesses to expand its payment network.

However, product analytics showed a gap between terminal availability and actual usage: many merchants processed few or no transactions through Upay, while intensive usage was concentrated in a small group.

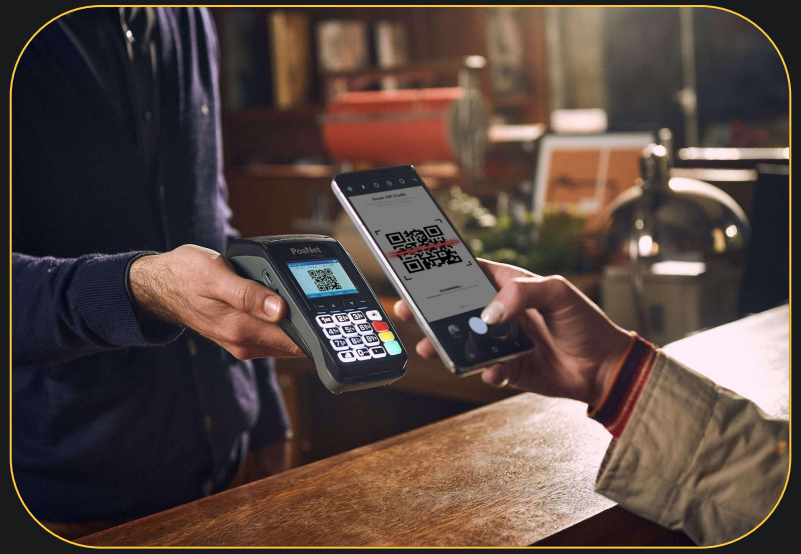
At the same time, the business was preparing two major changes:

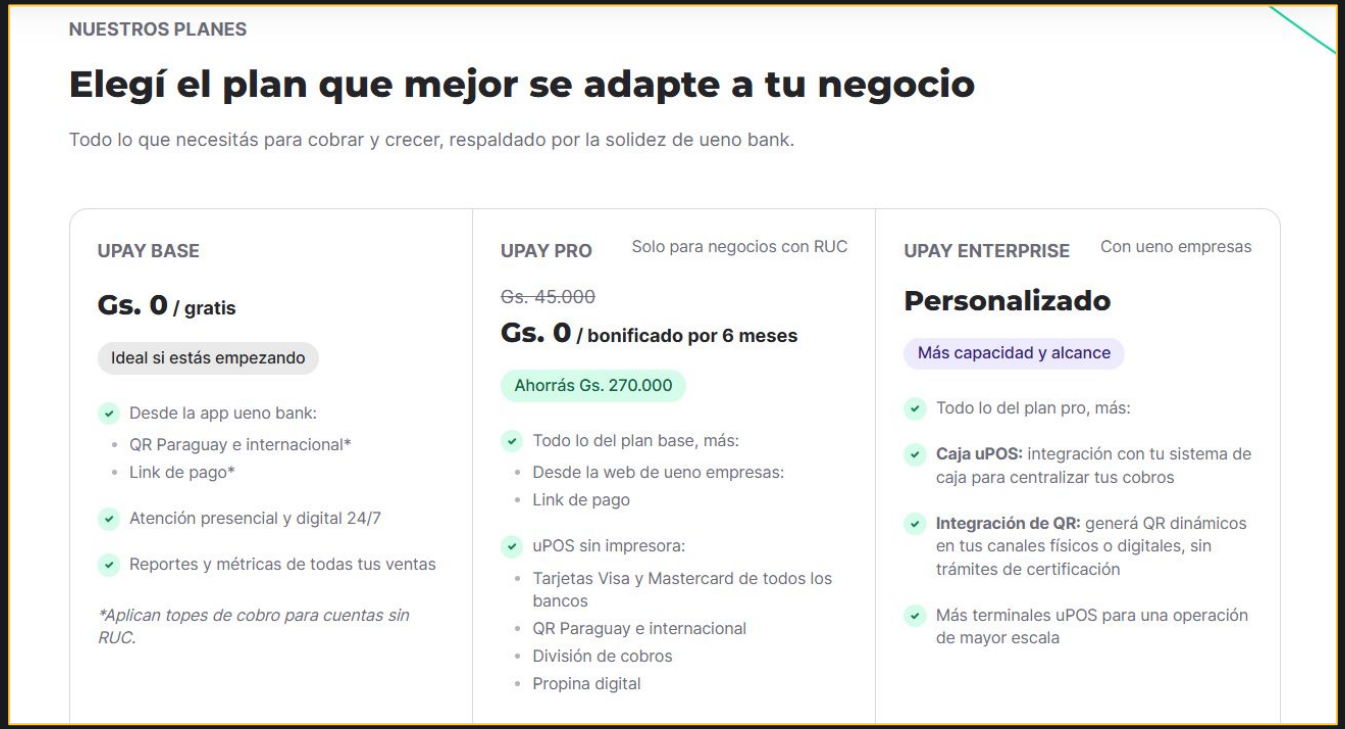
- A hardware upgrade to improve terminal performance
- The introduction of a tier-based subscription model

The challenge

How might Upay increase recurring use of its POS terminals while introducing a subscription model without weakening its value proposition or accelerating churn?

The challenge went beyond distributing new devices. We needed to understand what made merchants choose one payment provider over another, and what would give them a reason to keep using Upay in their everyday operations.





Upay landing page with official information about the subscription plans

Understanding merchant activity through product data

Using **Amplitude**, we analyzed transaction counts and processed monetary volume per segments of vendors across Q1 and Q2 2026.

We reviewed usage patterns to distinguish active, light, heavy and inactive users, and considered differences across autonomous workers, digitally enabled businesses, and larger multi-location operations.

This analysis helped us prioritize merchant segments for field research.

Our approach: Product analytics + in-context research

Partnering with Product and Service Design to investigate the factors behind merchant usage and payment-provider choice, we combined:

- Analysis of transaction activity in Amplitude.
- In-person merchant interviews and contextual observation in Asunción, PY.
- Exploration of merchants' payment workflows, operational needs, and experiences with competing providers.
- NPS + CSAT of Upay experience (including the web portal)

The goal was to connect observed product behavior with the real conditions shaping merchants' decisions at checkout, and also obtain insights from the proposed subscription model and the current value offered by Upay's existing features.

Mapping the Journey & Shaping Opportunities

Understanding the end-to-end experience, aligning stakeholders, and identifying opportunities to increase Upay usage.



1. Mapping the end-to-end service

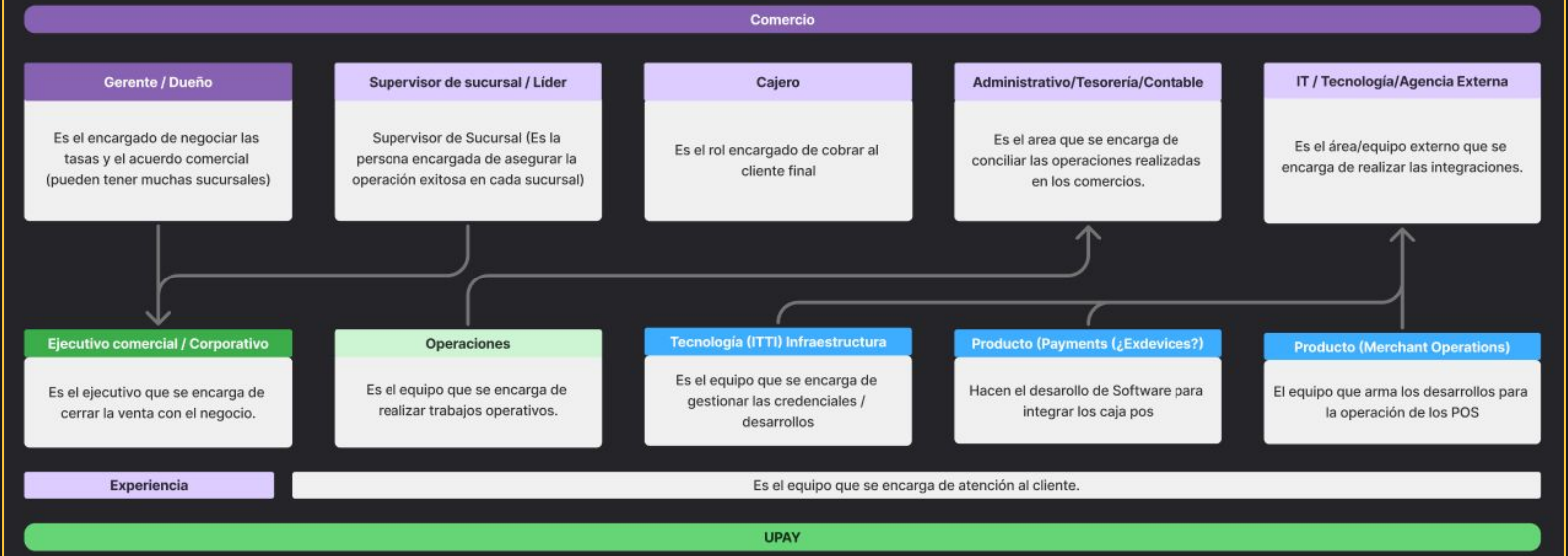
Before conducting field research, we collaborated with Product and Service Design to map the existing merchant experience, combining business knowledge with feedback previously collected from users.

We helped build a service blueprint covering the merchant journey from commercial agreement and product onboarding to integration, terminal installation, first use, and initial post-transaction reconciliation.

Case 6

Index

Estructura y áreas involucradas



Selected excerpts from collaborative Figma boards documenting the service blueprint, merchant use cases, and co-creation workshops conducted during Discovery.

Case 6

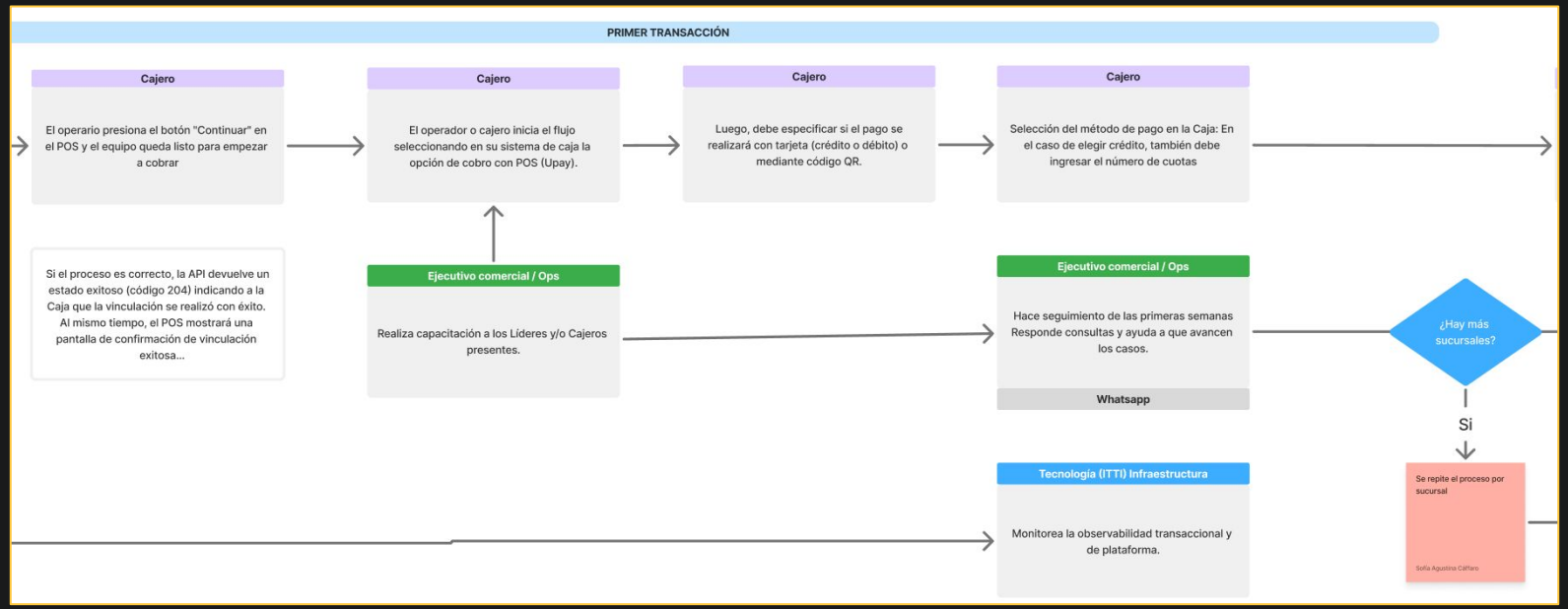
Index



Selected excerpts from collaborative Figma boards documenting the service blueprint, merchant use cases, and co-creation workshops conducted during Discovery.

Case 6

Index



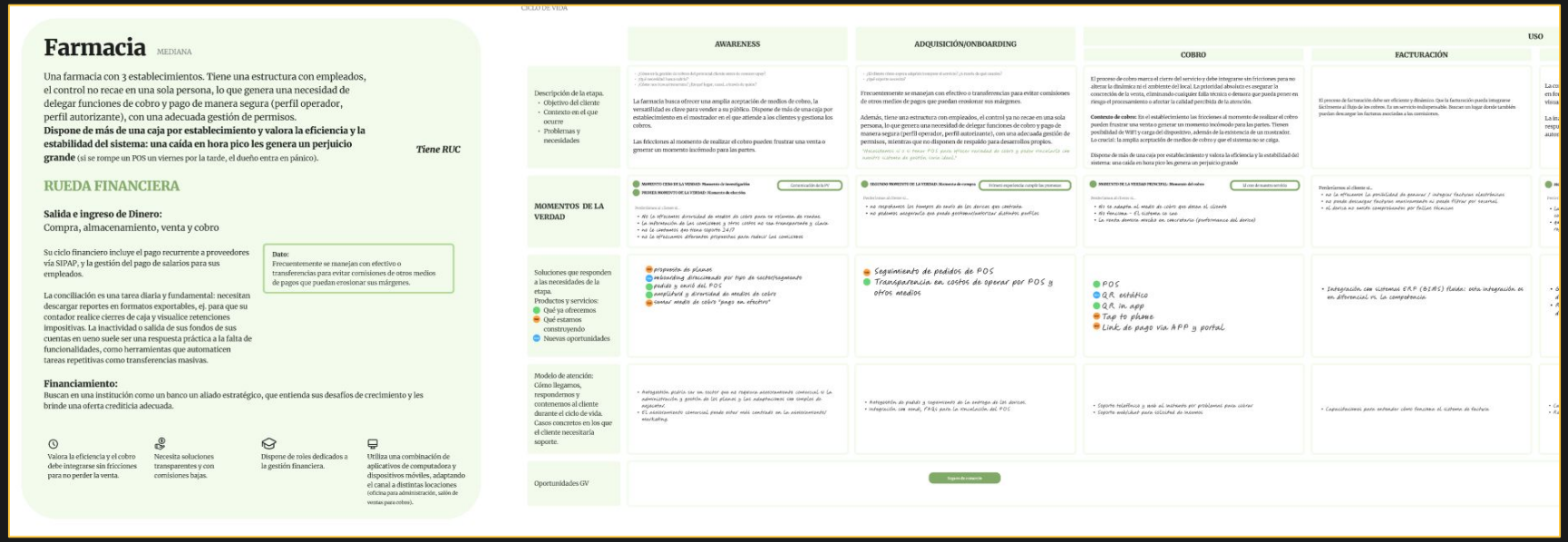
Selected excerpts from collaborative Figma boards documenting the service blueprint, merchant use cases, and co-creation workshops conducted during Discovery.

2. Redefining Profiles and Use cases

We defined the key teams and stakeholders involved in delivering the service, mapped relevant use cases, and refined merchant segments and profiles. This helped us establish a more structured view of how different types of businesses operated and interacted with UPay.

Case 6

Index



Farmacia MEDIANA

Una farmacia con 3 establecimientos. Tiene una estructura con empleados, el control no recae en una sola persona, lo que genera una necesidad de delegar funciones de cobro y pago de manera segura (perfil operador, perfil autorizante), con una adecuada gestión de permisos.
Dispone de más de una caja por establecimiento y valora la eficiencia y la estabilidad del sistema: una caída en hora pico les genera un perjuicio grande (si se rompe un POS un viernes por la tarde, el dueño entra en pánico).

Tiene RUC

RUEDA FINANCIERA

Salida e ingreso de Dinero:
Compra, almacenamiento, venta y cobro

Su ciclo financiero incluye el pago recurrente a proveedores vía SIPAP, y la gestión del pago de salarios para sus empleados.

La conciliación es una tarea diaria y fundamental: necesitan descargar reportes en formatos exportables, ej. para que su contador realice cierres de caja y visualice retenciones impositivas. La inactividad o salida de sus fondos de sus cuentas en ueno suele ser una respuesta práctica a la falta de funcionalidades, como herramientas que automaticen tareas repetitivas como transferencias masivas.

Dato:
Frecuentemente se manejan con efectivo o transferencias para evitar comisiones de otros medios de pagos que puedan erosionar sus márgenes.

Financiamiento:
Buscan en una institución como un banco un aliado estratégico, que entienda sus desafíos de crecimiento y les brinde una oferta crediticia adecuada.

Valora la eficiencia y el cobro debe integrarse sin fricciones para no perder la venta.

Necesita soluciones transparentes y con comisiones bajas.

Dispone de roles dedicados a la gestión financiera.

Utiliza una combinación de aplicativos de computadora y dispositivos móviles, adaptando el canal a distintas locaciones (oficina para administración, salón de ventas para cobros).

CICLO DE VIDA

	AWARENESS	ADQUISICIÓN/ONBOARDING	USO: COBRO	USO: FACTURACIÓN
Descripción de la etapa. • Objetivo del cliente • Contexto en el que ocurre • Problemas y necesidades	La farmacia busca ofrecer una amplia aceptación de medios de cobro, la versatilidad es clave para vender a su público. Dispone de más de una caja por establecimiento en el mostrador en el que atiende a los clientes y gestiona los cobros. Las fricciones al momento de realizar el cobro pueden frustrar una venta o generar un momento incómodo para las partes.	Frecuentemente se manejan con efectivo o transferencias para evitar comisiones de otros medios de pagos que puedan erosionar sus márgenes. Además, tiene una estructura con empleados, el control ya no recae en una sola persona, lo que genera una necesidad de delegar funciones de cobro y pago de manera segura (perfil operador, perfil autorizante), con una adecuada gestión de permisos, mientras que no disponen de resguardo para desarrollos propios.	El proceso de cobro marca el cierre del servicio y debe integrarse sin fricciones para no alterar la dinámica ni el ambiente del local. La prioridad absoluta es asegurar la concreción de la venta, eliminando cualquier falla técnica o demora que pueda poner en riesgo el procesamiento o afectar la calidad percibida de la atención. **Contexto de cobro:** En el establecimiento las fricciones al momento de realizar el cobro pueden frustrar una venta o generar un momento incómodo para las partes. Tienen posibilidad de WiFi y carga del dispositivo, además de la existencia de un mostrador. Lo crucial: la amplia aceptación de medios de cobro y que el sistema no se caiga. Dispone de más de una caja por establecimiento y valora la eficiencia y la estabilidad del sistema: una caída en hora pico les genera un perjuicio grande	El proceso de facturación debe ser eficiente y dinámico. Que la facturación pueda integrarse fácilmente al flujo de los otros. Es un servicio indispensable. Buscan un lugar donde cambien puedan descargar las facturas asociadas a las comisiones.
MOMENTOS DE LA VERDAD	MOMENTO CERO DE LA VERDAD: Momento de investigación — Comunicación de la PV PRIMER MOMENTO DE LA VERDAD: Momento de elección Preferiríamos si… • No la versatilidad diversidad de medios de cobro para no vitamina de ventas. • La información de los comisiones y otros costos no sea transparente y clara. • no la contenido que tenga soporte 24/7. • no la ofrezcamos diferentes propuestas para reducir los comisiones	SEGUNDO MOMENTO DE LA VERDAD: Momento de compra — Alcanzo experiencia cumplió las promesas Preferiríamos si… • no respetamos los tiempos de envío de los dorios que contrato. • no podemos asegurarle que pueda gestionar/controlar distintos perfiles	MOMENTO DE LA VERDAD PRINCIPAL: Momento del cobro — Si con de nuestro servicio Preferiríamos si… • No te adapte al medio de cobro que desea el cliente • No funciona - El sistema se cae. • La venta dorios medio en concreto (performance del dorio)	Preferiríamos al cliente si… • no la ofrecemos la posibilidad de generar / integrar facturas electrónicas • no pueda descargar facturas mensualmente ni pueda filtrar por secuela. • el dorio no venta comprobante por fallas técnicas
Soluciones que responden a las necesidades de la etapa. Productos y servicios: • Qué ya ofrecemos • Qué estamos construyendo • Nuevas oportunidades	• propuesta de planes • onboarding direccionado por tipo de sector/segmento • pedido y envió del POS • ampliando y diversidad de medios de cobro • sumar medio de cobro "pago en efectivo"	• Seguimiento de pedidos de POS • Transparencia en costos de operar por POS y otros medios	• POS • QR estático • QR in app • Tap to phone • Link de pago vía APP y portal	• Integración con sistemas ERP (BIAS) fluida: esta integración es un diferencial vs. la competencia.
Modelo de atención: Cómo llegamos, respondemos y contenemos al cliente durante el ciclo de vida. Casos concretos en los que el cliente necesitaría soporte.	• Autogestión gráfica sin un costo que no requiera acompañamiento comercial o la administración y gestión de los planes y las adquisiciones con canales de negociar. • El acompañamiento comercial puede estar más centrado en la adquisición/marketing.	• Autogestión de pedido y seguimiento de la entrega de los dorios. • Integración con email, FAQs para la resolución del POS	• Soporte telefónico y web al instante por problemas para cobrar • Soporte enfocado para solución de incidentes	• Capacitaciones para entender cómo funciona el sistema de facturación
Oportunidades GV	Soporte de compra/uso			

Selected excerpts from collaborative Figma boards documenting the service blueprint, merchant use cases, and co-creation workshops conducted during Discovery.

Case 6

Index



Feriante EMPRENDEDOR

Emprendedor unipersonal o negocio informal de muy pequeña escala, donde el dueño es simultáneamente **el productor, el vendedor y el administrador**. Su negocio se basa en la venta de productos de producción propia (artesanías, alimentos gourmet, ropa de diseño, arte, etc.) y **realiza la venta de sus productos en ferias locales o a través de redes sociales.**

No tiene RUC necesariamente.

RUEDA FINANCIERA

Para este perfil, la actividad comercial es una extensión indivisible de su vida personal. Operan bajo una lógica de autosuficiencia y liquidez inmediata, donde la tecnología debe funcionar como un acelerador simple de su día a día y nunca como una barrera burocrática.

Salida e ingreso de Dinero:
Compra, almacenamiento, venta y cobro

Sus fondos se acreditan en la cuenta recaudadora y utilizan ese mismo saldo para gastos personales, reponer insumos o mercadería, o pagar servicios básicos desde la App.

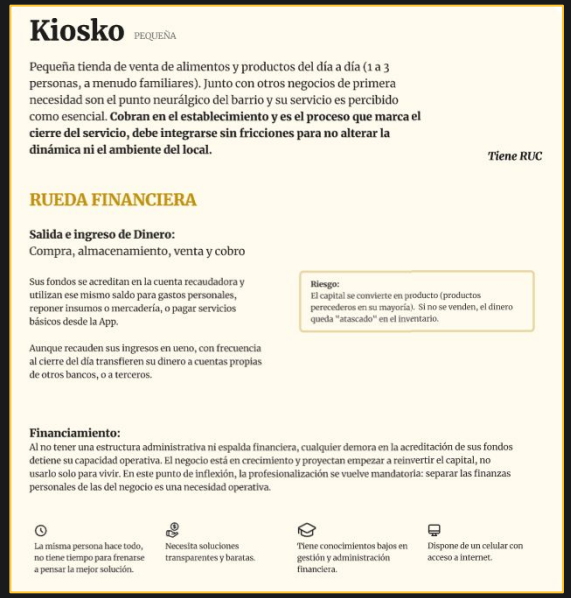
Riesgo:
El capital se convierte en producto. Si el producto no se vende rápido (por ejemplo, si llueve todo el fin de semana), el dinero se queda "atascado" en el inventario.

Aunque recauden sus ingresos en ueno, con frecuencia al cierre del día transfieren su dinero a cuentas propias de otros bancos, o a terceros.

"Ya tiene la solución en su bolsillo"

Financiamiento:
Al no tener una estructura administrativa ni espalda financiera, cualquier demora en la acreditación de sus fondos detiene su capacidad operativa.

- La misma persona hace todo, no tiene tiempo para frenarse a pensar la mejor solución.
- Necesita soluciones transparentes y baratas.
- Tiene conocimientos bajos en gestión y administración financiera.
- Dispone de un celular con acceso a internet.



Kiosko PEQUEÑA

Pequeña tienda de venta de alimentos y productos del día a día (1 a 3 personas, a menudo familiares). Junto con otros negocios de primera necesidad son el punto neurálgico del barrio y su servicio es percibido como esencial. **Cobran en el establecimiento y es el proceso que marca el cierre del servicio, debe integrarse sin fricciones para no alterar la dinámica ni el ambiente del local.**

Tiene RUC

RUEDA FINANCIERA

Salida e ingreso de Dinero:
Compra, almacenamiento, venta y cobro

Sus fondos se acreditan en la cuenta recaudadora y utilizan ese mismo saldo para gastos personales, reponer insumos o mercadería, o pagar servicios básicos desde la App.

Riesgo:
El capital se convierte en producto (productos perecederos en su mayoría). Si no se venden, el dinero queda "atascado" en el inventario.

Aunque recauden sus ingresos en ueno, con frecuencia al cierre del día transfieren su dinero a cuentas propias de otros bancos, o a terceros.

Financiamiento:
Al no tener una estructura administrativa ni espalda financiera, cualquier demora en la acreditación de sus fondos detiene su capacidad operativa. El negocio está en crecimiento y proyectan empezar a reinvertir el capital, no usarlo solo para vivir. En este punto de inflexión, la profesionalización se vuelve mandatoria: separar las finanzas personales de las del negocio es una necesidad operativa.

- La misma persona hace todo, no tiene tiempo para frenarse a pensar la mejor solución.
- Necesita soluciones transparentes y baratas.
- Tiene conocimientos bajos en gestión y administración financiera.
- Dispone de un celular con acceso a internet.



Retailer: hipermercado GRANDE

Organización robusta con nóminas estables, (aunque aún habitando espacios de informalidad) que, si bien aspira a una experiencia 100% digital y sin fricciones, enfrenta una realidad operativa compleja que la fuerza a trabajar con múltiples entidades financieras. **Tiene gran volumen de transacciones diarias en un entorno frenético dominado por la "ansiedad de fila" donde la presión por la velocidad magnifica cada segundo de demora y la tolerancia a la fricción es nula.**

Tiene RUC

RUEDA FINANCIERA

Su ciclo financiero es industrial; la automatización de las conciliaciones es prioritaria, requiriendo el cruce de datos masivos, como ventas, ingresos, transferencias a proveedores y nóminas.

Necesitan poder descargar reportes detallados y exportables para procesarlos externamente. A diferencia de las PyMEs, aquí aparece fuertemente la gestión de tesorería sofisticada: buscan optimizar procesos (pagos masivos) y potenciar saldos ociosos mediante inversiones corporativas (Fondos Mutuos, CDAs) para generar rendimientos financieros.

Son organizaciones con estructuras grandes y volumen masivo de transacciones. Habitualmente diversifican sus fondos en múltiples bancos según convenios estratégicos y conveniencia según cartera de productos y funcionalidades.

Su prioridad absoluta es la seguridad y la prevención de fraude, dado el alto riesgo reputacional que enfrentan. Habitualmente no tienen la misma urgencia de liquidez inmediata, pero exigen una precisión total en los datos para sus procesos internos, sujetos a auditorías internas y externas. Dado que tienen múltiples operadores en sus plataformas, requieren poder habilitar perfiles y accesos de forma autónoma y granular.

- Necesitan agilidad en el momento de cobro, pero no tienen urgencia de liquidez inmediata.
- Buscan convenios estratégicos y conveniencia según cartera de productos y funcionalidades.
- Operan con equipos dedicados y procesos estandarizados para conciliaciones, pagos y otras gestiones financieras, para lo que requieren funcionalidades robustas, que habiliten una operatoria fluida y eficiente.

Selected excerpts from collaborative Figma boards documenting the service blueprint, merchant use cases, and co-creation workshops conducted during Discovery.

3. Collaborative Workshops: exploring primary use

We facilitated collaborative workshops around a key business challenge: Bancard remained the default payment terminal at the checkout counter, while Upay was often left aside. The integration with the POS cash register created an opportunity to rethink this dynamic.

Working through real-life payment scenarios, we explored how the physical checkout setup, differentiated subscription plans, and in-store signage could become touchpoints for encouraging merchants to make UPay a more prominent part of their payment operations.

Case 6

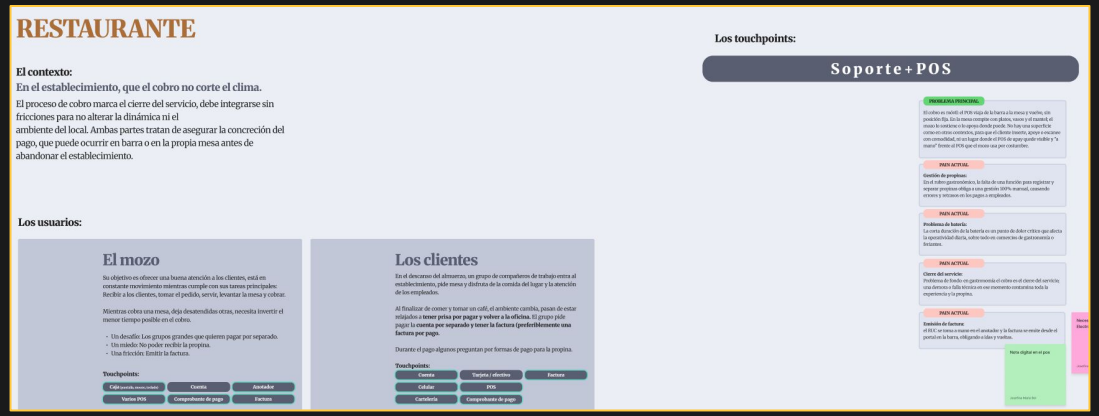
Index

Hoy, en el mostrador, el POS de Bancard sigue siendo el actor principal: está en el lugar de cobro, integrado y se usa por defecto. **El de upay queda al costado.** Ahora con Caja POS integrado podemos jugar distinto el partido.

Soporte físico y cartelería son dos touchpoints que suman al **escenario para obtener principalidad.**

Objetivos específicos

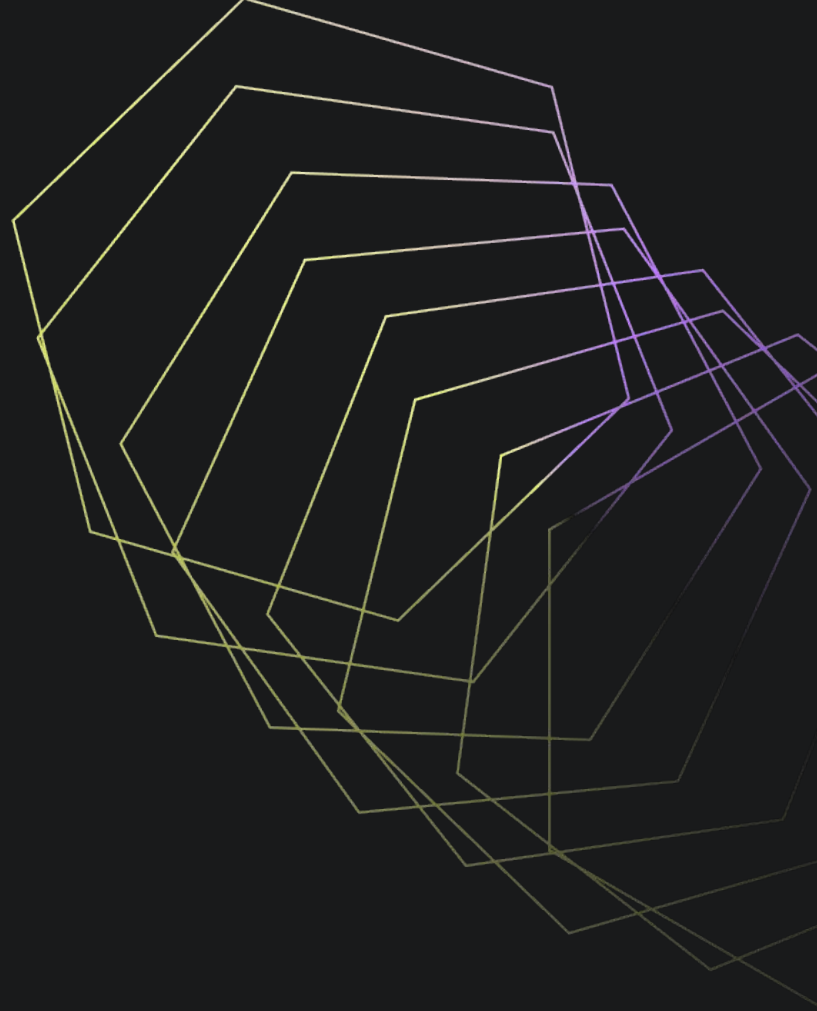
1. hagan que el **POS de upay sea el que se usa por defecto**
2. **bajen la fricción** del cobro para cajero y cliente
3. sean **viables de producir e instalar.**



This preliminary work helped align Product, Service Design, and Research around the service experience, clarify the main assumptions to investigate, and identify opportunities to explore and validate during field research.

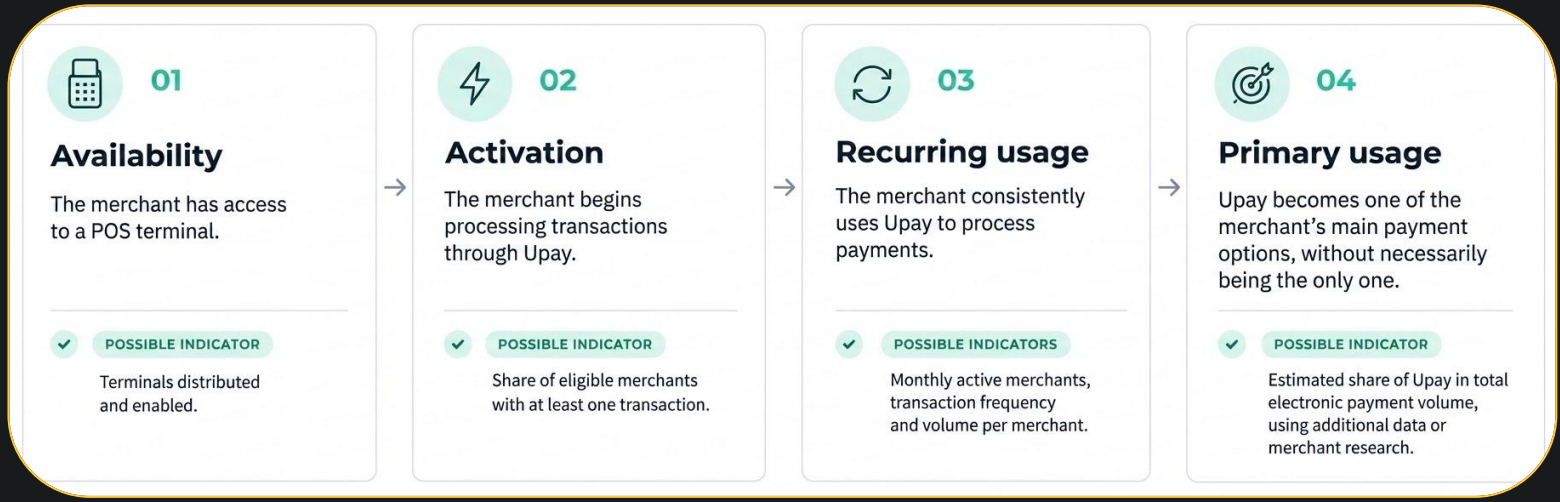
Into the Field

Market insights about the current experience and the perception of Upay and it's future.



Market Insights: Availability is not Adoption

Owning a POS terminal does not mean using it. And we identified four distinct stages of product adoption from the moment a merchant received a terminal to when Upay became of the it's main payment options.



Market Insights: Merchants optimize for completing the sale

Field research showed that merchants adapted to their customers' preferred payment methods, banks, digital wallets, and available promotions.

Several factors influenced the vendor's choice:

- **Reliability:** slow or unstable terminals could lead merchants to switch payment methods immediately.
- **Customer demand:** discounts, cashback, and installment offers influenced which payment methods customers preferred.
- **Payment flexibility:** limited QR interoperability restricted merchants' ability to accommodate different customer preferences.
- **Operational needs:** hospitality merchants also identified tipping as a relevant missing functionality

Risk and Impact Matrix

Index

Classifies the identified issues based on their likelihood of occurring in day-to-day operations and their negative impact on revenue or brand reputation.

Riesgo (Amenaza detectada)	Probabilidad	Impacto	Nivel de Riesgo
Pérdida de ventas por rechazo de tarjetas	Alta	Muy Alto	🔴 CRÍTICO
Cobros duplicados y crisis de confianza	Media	Muy Alto	🔴 CRÍTICO
Abandono del POS por falta de promociones	Alta	Alto	🟠 ALTO
Fricción operativa en horas pico (Hibernación)	Alta	Medio	🟠 ALTO
Inoperatividad en eventos/delivery (Batería)	Alta	Medio	🟡 MEDIO
Fuga x Propinas	Media	Medio	🟡 MEDIO

Extract of the matrix developed after in-situ research

Is “Principality” a real thing?

Primary usage could not be achieved through distribution alone. Upay needed to work reliably and remain competitive within the merchant’s broader payment ecosystem.

The merchant’s priority was always to complete the sale, not to commit to one payment network. So the concept of principality seemed to be more an expectation of us, than an empirical reality.

And our challenge was not simply increasing distribution or initial activation, but creating the conditions for merchants to keep choosing Upay over time.

Market Insights: Subscription requires a Clear Value Exchange

Merchants did not categorically reject a monthly subscription. Their willingness to pay depended on receiving tangible business value in return.

- At the time, Upay's customer-facing benefits were less compelling than those offered by competitors, particularly after some discounts and cashback promotions had been reduced.

Introducing a subscription therefore created a new challenge: merchants would need to perceive enough value in Upay's features and the wider bank ecosystem to justify an ongoing fee.

The findings helped the team reconsider the conditions of the subscription tiers and the incentives needed to support adoption.

Catálogo de Productos — Ecosistema UPay

	PLAN GRATUITO 🟢 Mundo Verde Sin RUC	PLAN GRATUITO 🟣 Mundo Violeta Con RUC	SUSCRIPCIÓN MENSUAL 🟣 Plan PRO Tarifa plana mensual	CORPORATIVO 🏢 Plan Enterprise Grandes cadenas
📱 Canales de Captura	• Cobros In-App (App UPay)	• Cobros In-App • POS Standalone se adquiere por separado	• Cobros In-App • POS Standalone ★ 1 equipo INCLUIDO	• POS Standalone (flota) • Caja POS integrado al software de caja
💻 Canales Digitales	• Link de Pago Nativo limitado a in-app	• Link de Pago Nativo (App) • Checkout Web (E-commerce) Ex Pagopar	• Link de Pago Nativo • Checkout Web	• Checkout Web (vía APIs)
💳 Medios de Pago	• QR In-App ueno · Bancard · PIX · Interop. • Tarjetas Crédito / Débito	• Tarjetas físicas y online • QR (App, Web y POS) • Billeteras Digitales Tigo · Personal · etc. • Bocas de Cobranza (Wepa) • Transferencias Bancarias	✅ Todos los medios habilitados Tarjetas · QR · Billeteras · Wepa · Apple/Google Pay	✅ Todos los medios habilitados
⚙️ Servicios VAS Valor Agregado	— Sin servicios VAS	• Facturación Electrónica (BIMS)	• Portal 3.0 reportes avanzados y conciliaciones • Facturación Electrónica (BIMS) • Modelo Agrupador Wepa cash-in / cash-out en el POS	• DevSite (autogestión API) • ABM Multi-sucursal / Multi-caja • Conciliación automatizada conexión a base de datos operativa • Facturación BIMS / Propia

Definition of product catalog by subscription plan - Upay 2026

Market Insights: Web portal wasn’t a standalone differentiator

Many merchants relied on internal systems or spreadsheets to manage sales, reporting, and reconciliation. Because the Upay portal showed information related to Upay transactions, it represented only one part of a merchant’s overall payment activity.

Opportunity identified: explore a more comprehensive merchant dashboard that could consolidate sales information across payment providers and support a more complete view of the business.

From product usage data to a more informed product strategy

The collaboration between Research, Product, and Service Design helped shift the conversation from POS distribution to recurring merchant usage and perceived value.

This research informed:

- the redefinition of subscription conditions
- refined the opportunity around QR interoperability
- challenged the assumption that Upay reporting portal was a sufficient differentiator on its own.



How would we know if these changes worked?

Activation

- Share of eligible merchants processing their first successful transaction.
- Time from terminal activation to first transaction.

Recurring usage and retention

- Monthly active merchants and transaction frequency per active merchant.
- Transaction volume per merchant and merchant inactivity or retention across periods.

How would we know if these changes worked?

Subscription performance

- Adoption and retention by plan.
- Downgrades or cancellations after introductory incentives expire.

Feature adoption

- QR transaction share, successful payment rates, and tipping usage where relevant.

Primary usage

- Estimate UPay's share of each merchant's total electronic payment activity using additional merchant data or research, rather than treating UPay transaction volume alone as proof of principal usage.

*Proposed next-step measurement framework: these were metrics to monitor on Q3-Q4, not outcomes measured by this research.

Thank you for reading



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